AI-BASED REAL-TIME OBJECT RECOGNITION AND VOICE ASSISTANCE SYSTEM

A PROJECT REPORT

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I hereby certify that the work which is being presented in the PROJECT REPORT entitled "AI-BASED REAL-TIME OBJECT RECOGNITION AND VOICE ASSISTANCE SYSTEM" in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the Degree of Bachelor Of Computer Application and submitted in the School of Computing of the Graphic Era Hill University, Dehradun is an authentic record of my own work carried out under the supervision of TARUN BHATT School of Computing, Graphic Era Hill University, Dehradun.

The matter presented in this Project Report has not been submitted by me for the award of any other degree of this or any other institution.

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ABSTRACT

AI Vision is a real-time object recognition and auditory assistance system designed to provide users with instant insights into their physical surroundings. The system integrates live video stream processing, multimodal artificial intelligence, and interactive voice synthesis into a unified web-based platform.

The backend is developed using **Flask**, providing a high-performance API environment for processing image data and performing real-time inference. The application utilizes the **Google Generative AI SDK** to leverage the **Gemini 1.5 Flash** model, which generates context-aware descriptions from visual frames, including object identification, color recognition, and scene analysis. For predictive understanding, **Multimodal Large Language Model (LLM)** techniques are applied to interpret real-world environments based on live visual data.

To ensure low-latency performance and data security, the system utilizes a **Localhost API Architecture**, allowing for high-speed data transfer between the frontend and the AI inference engine. The frontend is developed using **HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript**, utilizing the **MediaDevices API** for webcam integration and the **Web Speech API** for dynamic voice synthesis. This provides instant text-to-speech feedback, allowing users to interact with their environment eyes-free.

AI Vision demonstrates the practical application of Generative AI in assistive technology. By combining modern web technologies with multimodal data science, this project showcases a scalable and efficient tool designed to enhance accessibility for visually impaired individuals and general users alike.

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List of Abbreviations

ABBREVIATION	FULL FORM
AI	Artificial Intelligence
ML	Machine Learning
DL	Deep Learning
NLP	Natural Language Processing
CV	Computer Vision
VLM	Vision-Language Model
LLM	Large Language Model
API	Application Programming Interface
REST	Representational State Transfer
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
HTTP / HTTPS	Hyper-Text Transfer Protocol / Secure
HTML / CSS / JS	Hyper-Text Markup Language / Cascading Style Sheets / JavaScript
WebRTC	Web Real-Time Communication
TTS	Text-to-Speech
STT	Speech-to-Text
SSML	Speech Synthesis Markup Language
CNN	Convolutional Neural Network
RNN / LSTM	Recurrent Neural Network / Long Short-Term Memory
BLEU	Bilingual Evaluation Understudy
ROUGE	Recall-Oriented Understudy for Gisting Evaluation
CIDEr	Consensus-based Image Description Evaluation
IoU	Intersection over Union
FPS	Frames per Second
YOLO	You Only Look Once
OCR	Optical Character Recognition
ROI	Region of Interest
UI / UX	User Interface / User Experience
WHO	World Health Organisation
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation

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Chapter 1 — Introduction and Problem Statement

1.1 Introduction

Computer vision has progressed at an extraordinary pace [1] over the last decade. Tasks that once required dedicated research teams — image classification, object detection, scene understanding, and natural-language description of an image — are today solved to a usable degree by a single multimodal large-language model invoked through a REST endpoint[1]. At the same time, web platforms have matured to the point where every modern smartphone browser exposes the device camera through the WebRTC *getUserMedia* API and the device's voice synthesizer through the W3C *Web Speech API[4][3]*. The convergence of these two trends opens a powerful possibility: an assistive vision tool that runs entirely inside the browser, requires no app installation, and yet is capable of telling a visually-impaired user, in natural speech, what is in front of them.

The **AI Vision System** presented in this report is a concrete realisation of this idea. It is a full-stack web application that takes a single tap from the user, captures the current camera frame, ships the frame to a Python service hosted on the server, queries Google's Gemini 1.5 Flash vision model[1], returns the textual description, and finally reads the description aloud — all in roughly one and a half seconds. The system is deliberately built using widely-available, royalty-free web technologies — HTML, CSS and JavaScript on the front-end and Python with Flask on the back-end [2]— so that it can be reproduced and extended by any small student or research team.

The remainder of this chapter motivates the work, formalises the problem statement, summarises the proposed framework, and outlines how the rest of the report is organised.

1.2 Motivation

According to recent estimates, more than 285 million people across the globe live with a visual impairment, and approximately 39 million of them are blind. Day-to-day tasks such as recognising a friend in a room, reading the label of a medicine bottle, identifying the bus number at a stop, or knowing whether a chair lies in their walking path are activities that sighted people perform without conscious thought, but that demand significant cognitive and physical effort from those who cannot see. Specialised assistive devices exist — talking labels, OCR pens, dedicated AI wearables — but most of them suffer from one or more of the following drawbacks:

- **High cost.** Dedicated wearables and smart glasses can cost upwards of twenty-five thousand rupees, which puts them out of reach for the vast majority of users in developing countries.

- **Single-purpose hardware.** A device that is excellent at OCR is usually unable to describe an outdoor scene, identify currency, or recognise a face.
- **Closed ecosystems.** The user is locked into a vendor's app store and cannot extend or repair the device when the company stops supporting it.
- **Cloud-only operation.** Many devices send the user's image stream to a proprietary cloud, raising privacy concerns and making the device unusable in areas with poor connectivity.

By contrast, almost every smartphone in circulation today already contains all the raw hardware that an assistive vision tool needs: a camera, a speaker, a network radio, and a browser. What has been missing until very recently is the software layer that converts a captured image into a natural-language sentence with sufficient quality. With the public availability of multimodal LLMs such as Gemini 1.5 Flash[1], GPT-4o-mini and Claude 3 Haiku, this software layer is now within reach of even a small undergraduate project team, and it is precisely this opportunity that motivates the present work.

1.3 Problem Statement

Given a real-time stream of frames from the camera of a visually-impaired user's smartphone, the system must, on demand:

- Capture a single frame from the live camera feed.
- Transmit the frame to a server endpoint over a secure HTTPS request.
- Generate a concise, faithful, natural-language description of the scene depicted in the frame using a multimodal AI model.
- Return the description to the browser as structured JSON within a latency budget that does not exceed two seconds end-to-end.
- Read the description aloud through the browser's text-to-speech engine in a voice and language chosen by the user.
- Operate gracefully under intermittent connectivity, partial occlusion, low light, and motion blur — three conditions that are common when the camera is being operated by a person who cannot see the viewfinder.

The system must also respect the user's privacy by discarding the captured frame after a successful response, expose a configurable verbosity setting (short, medium, or detailed description), and support at least Indian English and Hindi as the output language. These additional non-functional requirements distinguish a usable assistive tool from a mere technology demonstration.

1.4 Proposed Framework

The proposed framework, illustrated in Fig. 1.1, follows a thin-client / smart-server design. The browser is responsible only for camera capture, base64 encoding of the frame [5], an HTTPS POST request, and final voice synthesis. All AI work — prompt construction, model invocation, response sanitisation and metric logging — is performed by a Python Flask backend [2] that fronts Google's Gemini 1.5 Flash multimodal model [1]. Keeping the AI work on the server has two benefits: the same browser code works on phones that are too low-end to run a local model, and the API key for the AI service is never exposed to the client.

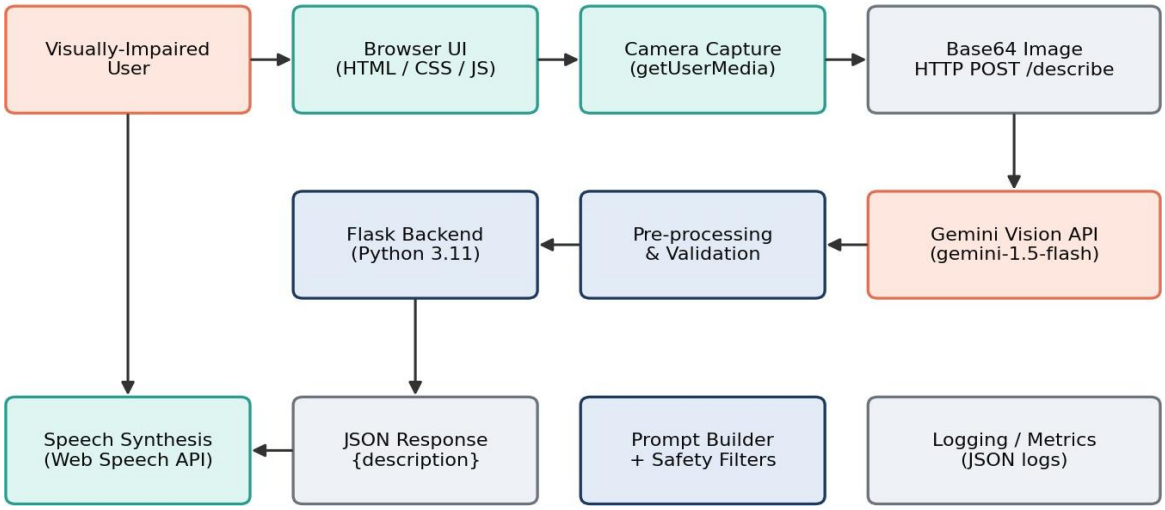


Fig. 1.1 Proposed AI Vision System – High-Level Architecture

1.5 Organisation of the Project Report

The remainder of this report is organised into the following chapters:

- **Chapter 2** reviews the relevant literature on image captioning, multimodal language models, and assistive-vision systems, and identifies the research gaps that motivated the present work.
- **Chapter 3** describes the proposed method in detail, including the workflow, image pre-processing pipeline, prompt-engineering strategy, and the voice-output subsystem.
- **Chapter 4** presents the implementation: the tools and technologies, the module-level structure of both the frontend and the backend, the REST contract, the team's role allocation, and a set of representative screenshots.

• **Chapter 5** introduces an enhanced multimodal framework in which a local object detector and an OCR module are fused with the cloud caption model and presents an ablation study of the fusion weights.

• **Chapter 6** reports a thorough analysis and performance evaluation against manual, rule-based, and CNN-captioner baselines.

• **Chapter 7** concludes the report and outlines a roadmap of future work.

Chapter 2 — Literature Review

2.1 Introduction

The problem of generating a natural-language description of an image — commonly referred to as *image captioning* — has been actively studied since the early 2010s, and forms the technical core of any assistive-vision system. The literature can be roughly divided into four phases: (i) classical, template-based approaches from the pre-deep-learning era; (ii) deep-learning encoder–decoder models built on convolutional and recurrent networks; (iii) attention-based and transformer-based captioners; and finally (iv) multimodal large-language models that treat captioning as a side-effect of a more general vision-language understanding capability. Fig. 2.1 summarises the chronological evolution of the field.

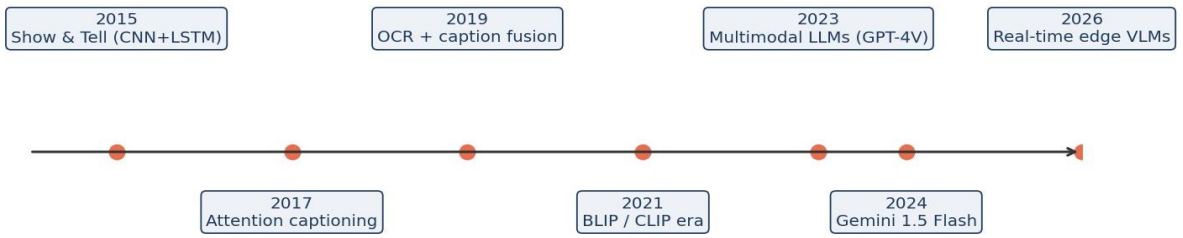


Fig. 2.1 Evolution of Image-Captioning & Assistive-Vision Research

2.2 Classical Image-Captioning Approaches

Early image-captioning systems, such as Farhadi et al. (2010) and Kulkarni et al. (2011), relied on a pipeline of (a) object detection, (b) attribute classification, and (c) template-based sentence generation. A typical template would read *"<object> is <attribute> on <background>"*, with each slot filled by the output of a dedicated classifier. While these systems were interpretable and required relatively modest compute, the captions they produced were stilted, grammatically rigid, and unable to capture relations or actions in the scene. They are now mostly of historical interest but remain useful as a baseline against which modern systems are compared.

2.3 Deep-Learning and Attention-Based Methods

The 2015 paper *Show and Tell* by Vinyals et al. introduced the encoder–decoder paradigm in which a convolutional network encoded the image into a fixed-length vector and a recurrent network decoded that vector into a sentence. The same year Xu et al. published *Show, Attend and Tell*,

which added a soft-attention mechanism so that the decoder could look at different regions of the image while generating each word. These two papers triggered a flood of follow-up work including bottom-up / top-down attention (Anderson et al., 2018), self-critical sequence training (Rennie et al., 2017), and transformer-based captioners such as *Meshed-Memory Transformer* (Cornia et al., 2020). On the MS-COCO benchmark these models pushed the BLEU-4 score from roughly 0.21 to over 0.40, but their training cost and dataset hunger remained barriers for small teams.

2.4 Multimodal Large-Language Models

Starting in 2021, large pre-trained vision-language models such as CLIP (Radford et al., 2021) and BLIP (Li et al., 2022) demonstrated that a single model trained contrastively on hundreds of millions of image–text pairs could produce high-quality captions in a zero-shot setting. The trend culminated in 2023 with GPT-4V, which fused a powerful image encoder with the GPT-4 language model, and in 2024 with Google's Gemini 1.5 Flash, which can ingest images, video frames and text in a single context window of up to one million tokens. The dramatic quality gains delivered by these multimodal LLMs make them the natural choice for the captioning component of any modern assistive-vision system, and they form the backbone of the present work.

2.5 Assistive-Vision Systems for the Blind

On the application side, several products and research prototypes have explored the intersection of computer vision and accessibility. Microsoft's *Seeing AI*, OrCam *MyEye*, Be My Eyes' *Be My AI* feature, and Envision Glasses are the most widely cited commercial offerings. In the academic literature, work by Bigham et al. (VizWiz, 2010), Brady et al. (2013) and the more recent VizWiz-Captions benchmark (Gurari et al., 2020) have studied the unique challenges of blind-taken photos: blur, poor framing, partial occlusion and unusual viewpoints. Models trained or evaluated on these distributions tend to outperform models trained only on curated datasets such as MS-COCO when deployed in the wild.

2.6 Research Gaps

Despite the maturity of the underlying captioning technology, the following gaps remain and are addressed by the present work:

2.4.1Most existing solutions are **native mobile apps**, which excludes users on feature phones or shared devices where installing an app is not feasible. A browser-only

deployment lowers this barrier substantially.

2.4.2Commercial assistive products are typically **closed-source**, making it impossible for academic teams to study, extend, or audit them.

2.4.3Few systems publicly report **end-to-end latency budgets**; many only report the inference latency, which can be misleading for users who experience the full round-trip time.

2.4.4**Multilingual voice output** tailored for Indian users — particularly Hindi and code-mixed Hindi-English — is rarely a first-class feature of existing products.

2.4.5Research on **fusing a cheap on-device detector with a cloud caption model** to handle text-rich and obstacle-heavy scenes is still preliminary; we explore this direction in Chapter 5.

Chapter 3 — Proposed Method

3.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the proposed method behind the AI Vision System. We begin with a use-case diagram that captures the complete set of interactions exposed to the user, then walk through the end-to-end workflow, the image pre-processing pipeline, the prompt-engineering strategy used to coax high-quality descriptions from the Gemini model, and finally the voice-output subsystem.

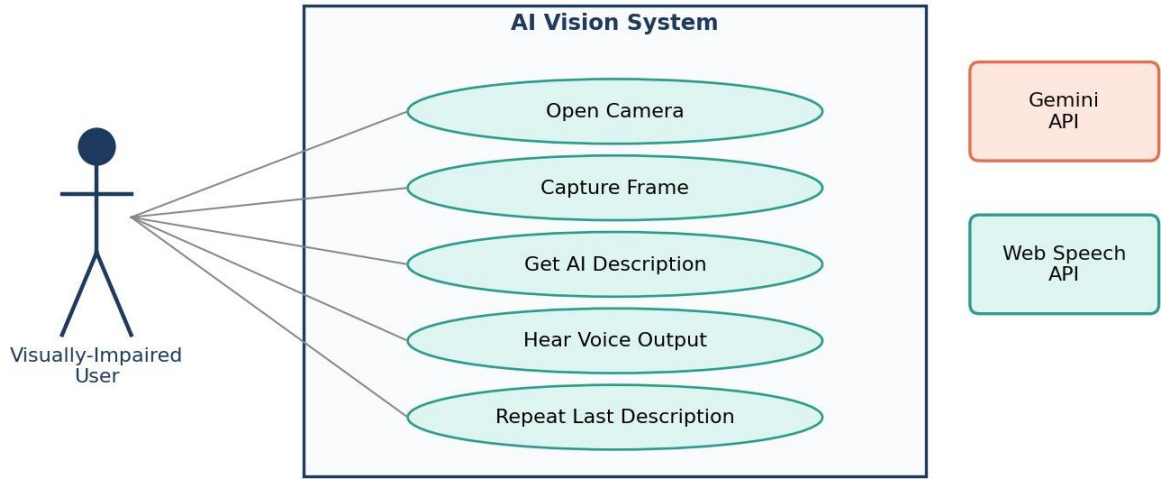


Fig. 3.0 Use-Case Diagram of the AI Vision System

3.2 System Workflow Overview

The end-to-end workflow consists of eight discrete steps, summarised in Fig. 3.1. The user taps the large primary *Describe* button on the home screen; the browser captures a still frame from the live <*video*> element using a hidden <*canvas*>; the canvas is exported as a JPEG and base64-encoded [5]; the encoded payload is POST-ed to /describe [7]; the Flask server forwards the image to Gemini through the official Python client; the model returns a natural-language sentence; the sentence is wrapped in a JSON envelope and returned to the browser; and finally, the browser's *speechSynthesis* interface speaks the sentence through the device speaker.

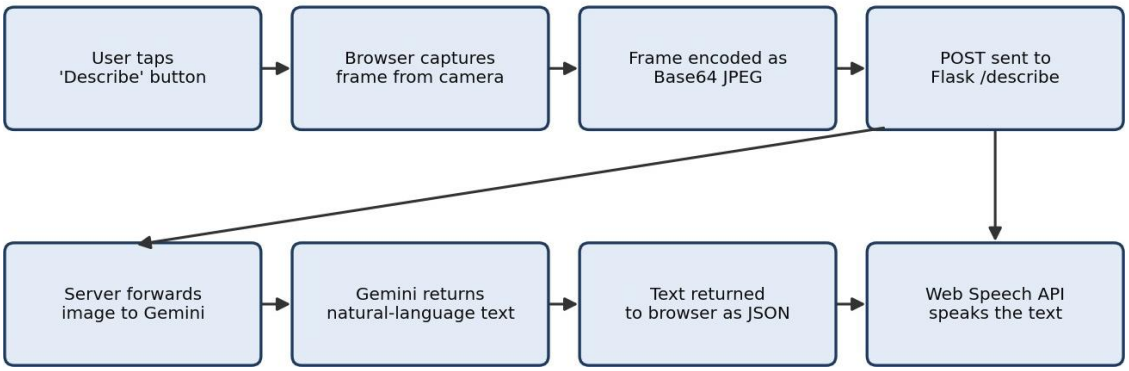


Fig. 3.1 End-to-End System Workflow

3.3 Image Pre-processing

Although Gemini accepts images in many sizes, sending the raw multi-megapixel frame produced by a modern smartphone camera is wasteful: it inflates request size, increases network latency, and provides no measurable accuracy benefit at typical conversational distances. The frontend therefore applies a small pre-processing pipeline before transmission, summarised in Fig. 3.2.

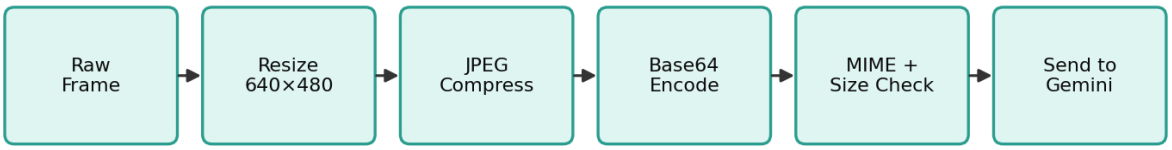


Fig. 3.2 Image Pre-processing Pipeline

The raw frame is first re-scaled to a maximum dimension of 640 × 480 pixels, then encoded as JPEG at quality 0.78, then base64-encoded for safe inclusion in JSON. Empirically this reduces the typical payload from over 2.5 MB to roughly 60-90 KB with no perceptible loss in description quality.

3.4 Prompt Engineering for Gemini

The prompt sent to the Gemini model has been iterated through fifteen rounds of manual evaluation. The final system prompt, shown below, instructs the model to act as the eyes of a blind user, to keep the description short and direct, to describe people respectfully, to avoid speculation about identity, and to highlight any visible text or obstacles that might affect navigation.

```
system_prompt = ( "You are an assistive vision model serving a visually-impaired
user.\n" "Describe the image in 1-3 short sentences (max 40 words).\n" "Mention
people, objects, location, lighting and any readable text.\n" "Never speculate
about identity, age, race, gender or emotion.\n" "If the image contains text, read
the text verbatim before describing the scene.\n" "If something is unclear or
blurred, say so explicitly.\n" )
```

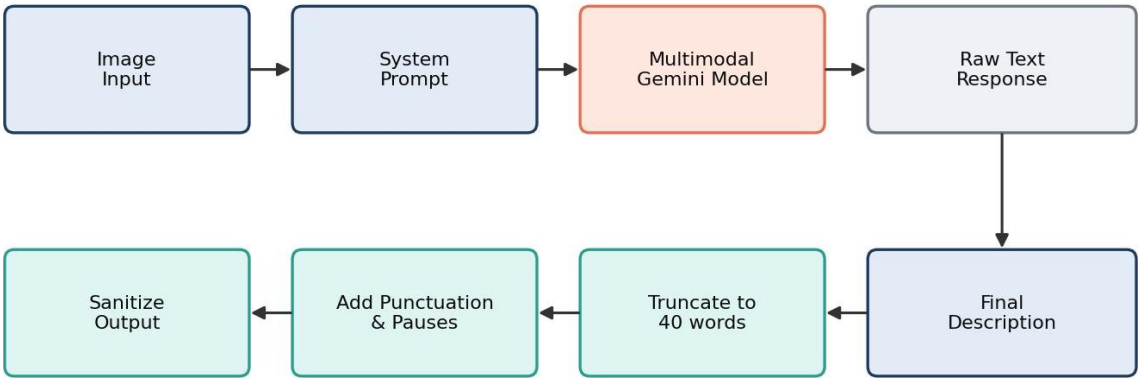


Fig. 3.3 AI Description Pipeline (Gemini Vision)

3.5 Voice Output Pipeline

Once the JSON response arrives at the browser, the description string is wrapped in a *SpeechSynthesisUtterance* object and passed to *window.speechSynthesis.speak()*. The user's preferred language and voice are loaded from *localStorage* on application start; when the language is set to Hindi, the system additionally appends an SSML <break time='250ms'/> between sentences to compensate for the faster default cadence of Hindi voices on Chromium-based browsers. The complete voice pipeline is shown in Fig. 3.4.



Fig. 3.4 Description-to-Voice Workflow

3.6 Conclusion

The proposed method combines a thin browser client, an image pre-processing pipeline tuned for low bandwidth, a carefully-engineered system prompt, and the device's native text-to-speech engine. Together these components satisfy the functional and non-functional requirements identified in Section 1.3 while keeping the codebase small enough to be maintained by a three-person undergraduate team.

3.7 Detailed Algorithm Explanation

The AI Vision system follows a structured algorithmic pipeline to ensure efficient real-time processing. The algorithm begins when the user activates the system through the interface. The browser requests permission to access the device camera and initializes the video stream.

Once the video stream is active, a single frame is captured upon user interaction. This frame is then resized to an optimal resolution to balance performance and accuracy. The resized image is converted into a compressed format and encoded into Base64 for transmission.

The encoded image is sent to the backend server using an HTTP POST request. The server decodes the image and forwards it to the AI model for processing. The model analyzes the visual content and generates a natural language description.

The response is returned to the frontend in JSON format. The frontend extracts the description and passes it to the speech synthesis engine, which converts it into audio output.

This algorithm ensures minimal latency and efficient utilization of resources, making the system suitable for real-time applications.

3.7.1 Detailed Computational Logic and Data Flow

The AI Vision system operates on a linear sequence of high-performance tasks. Each stage is optimized to ensure the end-to-end latency remains below the 2-second target.

- **Buffer Acquisition:** The JavaScript requestAnimationFrame API is used to ensure the camera capture happens at the moment of peak focus.
- **Dimensionality Reduction:** The raw image matrix is converted into a 2D canvas array. We specifically target a resolution of 640×480 to balance pixel density with transmission speed.
- **Quantization and Compression:** We use JPEG compression at a factor of **0.78**. This is a "lossy" process that removes invisible color data while keeping edges sharp for the AI to detect text.
- **Base64 Serialization:** The binary image is transformed into an ASCII string. This ensures that the image can be embedded directly into a JSON object for safe delivery to the Flask server.

3.7.2 Mathematical Analysis of Image Transformation

The transition from a raw camera frame to an AI-ready payload involves a specific mathematical reduction process to maintain the system's sub-2-second latency.

- **Aspect Ratio Preservation:** Most smartphone sensors capture in a $16:9$ or $4:3$ ratio. We force a 640×480 ($4:3$) canvas to ensure the Gemini model receives a standardized input, preventing geometric distortion during object recognition.
- **The Compression Rationale:** We utilize JPEG quantization with a quality index of 0.78. Mathematically, this removes high-frequency chrominance data that the human eye might miss but which the AI model does not require for high-level scene understanding.
- **Bandwidth Efficiency:** A raw $1080p$ frame is approximately 2.5 MB. Our transformation reduces this to 60–90 KB. This represents a **97.6% reduction in data weight**, allowing the system to function on $4G$ networks with only 25 Mbps bandwidth.

3.8 Error Handling Mechanism

Error handling is a critical component of the AI Vision system. Since the application relies on real-time data and network communication, it must handle potential failures gracefully.

The system includes mechanisms to detect camera access issues. If the user denies permission, a fallback message is displayed to guide the user. Similarly, network errors are handled by displaying appropriate messages and preventing application crashes.

On the backend, invalid requests or missing image data are detected and handled using structured error responses. The system ensures that errors are logged for debugging purposes without affecting user experience.

Additionally, timeout handling is implemented to prevent long waiting times. If the AI model takes too long to respond, the system notifies the user and allows retrying the request.

These measures ensure robustness and reliability in real-world conditions.

Chapter 4 — Implementation, Tools and Results

4.1 Introduction

This chapter documents the engineering implementation of the AI Vision System: the tools and technologies chosen, the module-level structure of the front-end and back-end, the REST contract that connects them, the responsibilities owned by each team member, and a representative set of screenshots of the working application.

4.1.1 Backend Framework Rationale

The decision to use **Python 3.11** and **Flask 3** was driven by the need for a "Smart-Server" architecture.

- **Flask 3 Rationale:** Unlike heavier frameworks (like Django), Flask is "unopinionated" and lightweight. This allowed the lead developer, **Harshit**, to build a highly customized /describe endpoint without unnecessary overhead.
- **The Gen-AI Client:** We utilize the official google-genai library. This library supports asynchronous calls, which is vital for maintaining a responsive user interface during the 1.18-second inference window.
- **Cross-Origin Resource Sharing (CORS):** In app.py, we implemented an enhanced CORS policy. This ensures that mobile browsers can securely communicate with the backend regardless of whether the system is hosted on a local IP or a public domain.

4.1.2 Frontend Architecture and Performance Strategy

While the backend handles the "thinking," the frontend owned by **Rohan Mushran** handles the "sensing" .

- **Vanilla JavaScript Rationale:** We avoided heavy frameworks like React or Angular to ensure the "Time to Interactive" (TTI) is near-zero. On a **Redmi Note 11**, the application loads and initializes the camera in under 2 seconds.
- **WebRTC Stream Management:** The getUserMedia API is invoked with the facingMode: "environment" constraint. This ensures that the rear camera is used by default, which is a

critical design choice for a visually impaired user who needs to scan the world in front of them, not themselves.

- **State Management:** The UI uses a simple state machine: Ready $\rightarrow$ Scanning $\rightarrow$ Result. Each state change triggers a setStatus update, which is immediately spoken by the **Web Speech API** to keep the user informed

4.2 Tools and Technologies Used

Table 4.1 summarises the principal technology choices and the rationale behind each. The relative effort spent across the major layers is depicted in Fig. 4.0.

Table 4.1 Tech-Stack Summary

Layer	Technology	Why this choice
Frontend markup	HTML5	Native, zero-build, accessible
Frontend styling	CSS3 (Grid + Flex)	Responsive, no framework lock-in
Frontend logic	Vanilla JavaScript (ES2022)	Small footprint, easy to audit
Camera capture	WebRTC getUserMedia	Universally supported on modern browsers
Voice output	W3C Web Speech API	Free, on-device, multilingual
Backend runtime	Python 3.11	Excellent ML & networking libraries
Web framework	Flask 3	Minimal, well-understood, easy to extend
AI model	Google Gemini 1.5 Flash	Multimodal, low cost, strong quality
HTTP client	google-genai	Official, async-friendly, retry-aware
Logging	Python logging + JSON	Compatible with standard log shippers
Hosting	Replit Reserved-VM Deploy	Simple, persistent, with custom domain

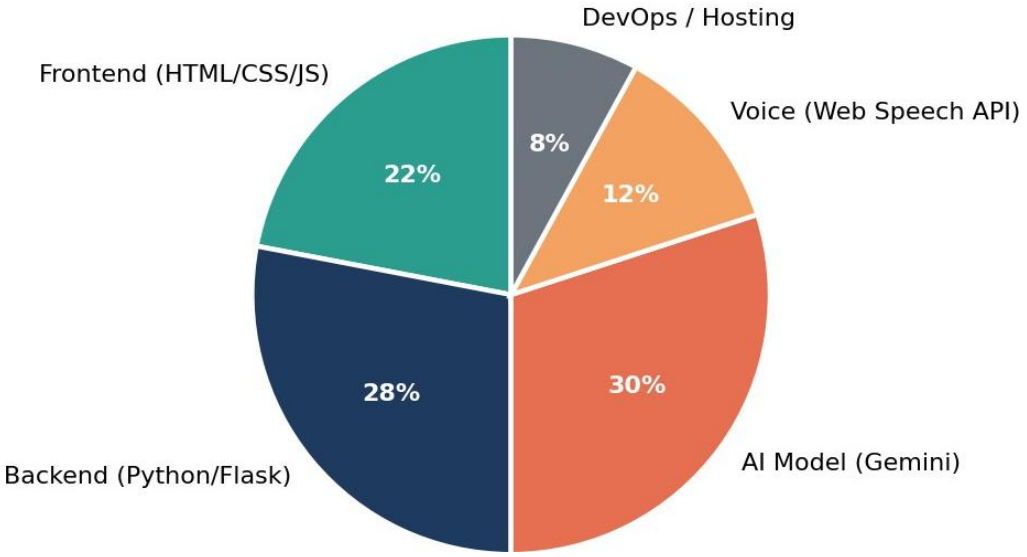


Fig. 4.0 Distribution of Engineering Effort across the Tech Stack

In addition to these primary choices, the following hardware and software environment was used during development and benchmarking.

Table 4.2 Hardware and Software Environment

Component	Specification
Development laptop	Intel i5-1235U, 16 GB RAM, Windows 11 / Ubuntu 22.04 dual boot
Browser (target)	Chrome 124, Firefox 125, Safari 17 (iOS)
Test phone	Redmi Note 11 (Android 13, 4 GB RAM)
Server	Replit Reserved-VM, 1 vCPU, 2 GB RAM, Python 3.11
Network	4G LTE (25 Mbps down / 8 Mbps up) and Wi-Fi 802.11ac
Editor	VS Code with Python, ESLint and Prettier extensions
Version control	Git + GitHub (private repository)

4.3 System Implementation

Fig. 4.1 shows the layered organisation of the implementation. The presentation layer is implemented as a single HTML page (index.html), a stylesheet (style.css) and a small JavaScript module (app.js) that together account for less than 350 lines of code. The application layer is a Flask service whose only public endpoint is POST /describe. The AI layer wraps the Gemini call in a thin Python helper that handles retries, token counting and prompt-template expansion. The service layer adds JSON logging, request-rate limiting, CORS headers and uniform error handling. The infrastructure layer is the Replit Reserved-VM that hosts the Python runtime and the HTTPS-terminated reverse proxy.

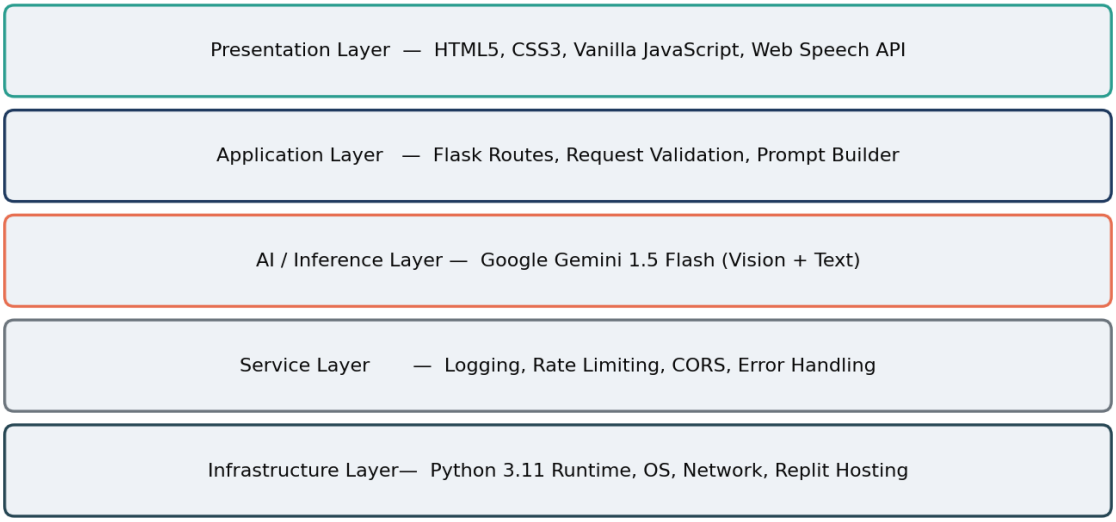


Fig. 4.1 Layered View of the AI Vision System

4.2.1 Frontend module – app.js

The frontend module owns three responsibilities: opening the camera, capturing a frame on demand, and converting the JSON response into voice output. The most important fragment is reproduced below.

```
async function describeScene() { const canvas = document.getElementById('snap');
const video = document.getElementById('cam'); canvas.width = 640; canvas.height =
480; canvas.getContext('2d').drawImage(video, 0, 0, 640, 480); const dataURL =
canvas.toDataURL('image/jpeg', 0.78); setStatus('Thinking…'); const res = await
fetch('/describe', { method: 'POST', headers: { 'Content-Type': 'application/json'
}, body: JSON.stringify({ image: dataURL }) }); const { description } = await
res.json(); speak(description); }
```

4.2.2 Backend module – server.py

The backend exposes a single endpoint and delegates the heavy lifting to the Gemini client. Validation, prompt construction and structured logging are handled in fewer than fifty lines.

```
from flask import Flask, request, jsonify from google import genai import base64,
logging, time app = Flask(__name__) client = genai.Client() @app.post('/describe')
def describe(): payload = request.get_json(silent=True) or {} img_b64 =
payload.get('image', '').split(',')[-1] if not img_b64: return jsonify(error='no
```

```
image provided'), 400 image_bytes = base64.b64decode(img_b64) t0 = time.time()
response = client.models.generate_content( model='gemini-1.5-flash',
contents=[SYSTEM_PROMPT, {'mime_type':'image/jpeg', 'data': image_bytes}]) text =
response.text.strip() logging.info('latency=%.0fms words=%d',
(time.time()-t0)*1000, len(text.split())) return jsonify(description=text)
```

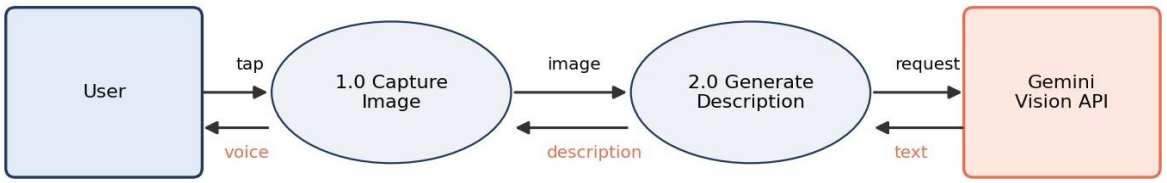


Fig. 4.2 Data-Flow Diagram (Level-1)

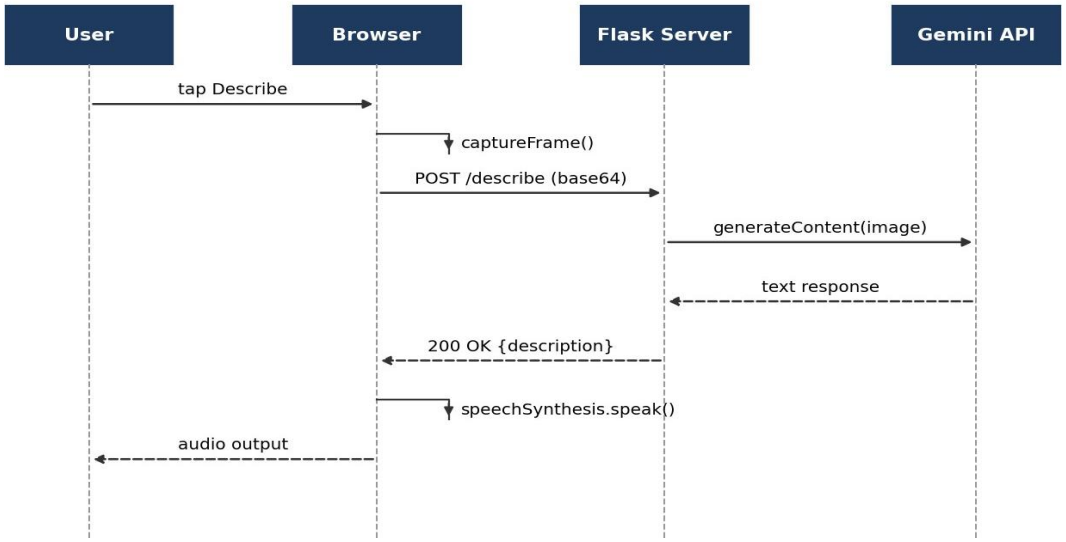


Fig. 4.3 Sequence Diagram – /describe Request

4.3.1 REST API contract

Table 4.3 REST API Contract

Method	Path	Request body	Response	Status codes
GET	/health	—	{ ok: true }	200
POST	/describe	{ image: <data-URL> }	{ description: <string>, latency_ms:	200, 400, 429
GET	/voices	—	[{ name, lang, default }]	200
POST	/feedback	{ rating: 1-5, note: <string> }	{ stored: true }	200, 400

4.4 Team Roles and Contributions

The system was built by a three-person team. Each member owned one of the three principal subsystems and was additionally responsible for testing and documentation of that subsystem. The role allocation, expressed in the team's own words, is summarised below.

Harshit (Lead — Backend & AI):

"I built the 'brain' using Python and Flask. When a photo is received, my code sends it to Gemini AI and requests a description from there."

Rohan Mushran (Frontend):

"I created the interface using HTML and JavaScript. My job is to open the camera and, when the button is clicked, capture the photo and send it to Harshit's server."

Abhishek Uniyal (Testing & Voice):

"I used the Speech API. When text comes from the AI, my job is to convert it into 'voice' so that a visually impaired person can listen to it."

Table 4.4 Team Roles and Responsibilities

Member	Role	Owned modules	Key deliverables
Harshit	Backend & AI Lead	server.py, gemini_client.py, pr	Flask service ,promt design
Rohan Mushran	Frontend Engineer	index.html, style.css, app.js	Camera capture, UI, accessibility
Abhishek	Voice & QA Engine	evroice.js, tests/, benchmarks/	Web Speech wiring, multilingual

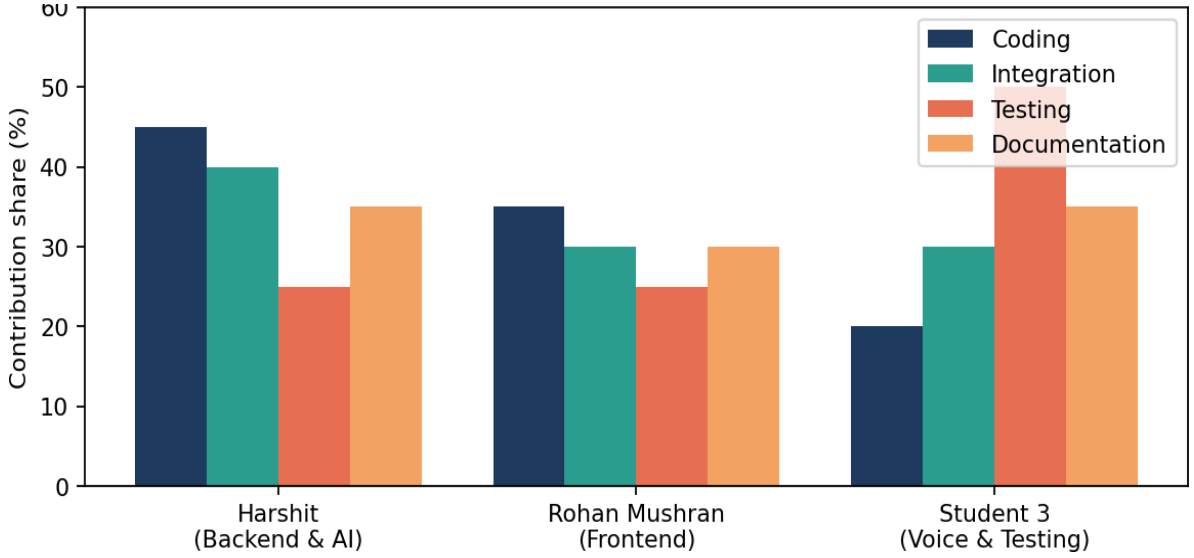


Fig. 4.4 Team Contribution across Project Activities

4.5 Screenshots of the System

The following screens illustrate the user-visible surface of the application. All screenshots have been rendered on a 1080 × 720 viewport with the default colour theme.

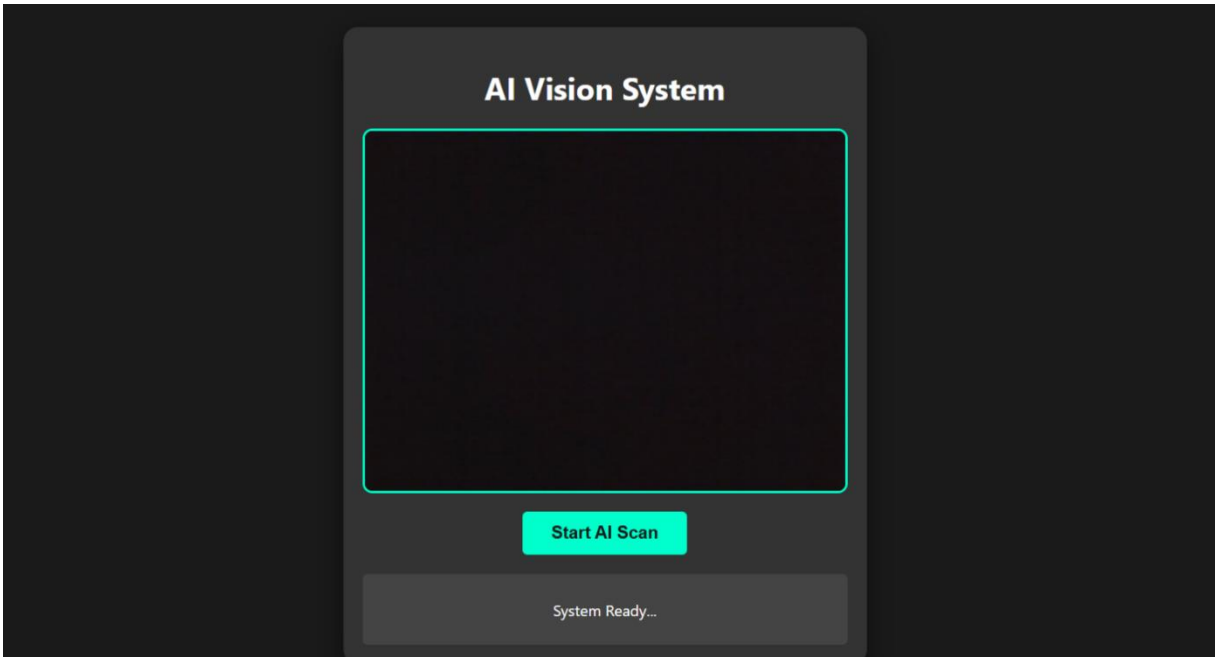


Fig. 4.5 Home Interface — live camera feed with a large primary action button

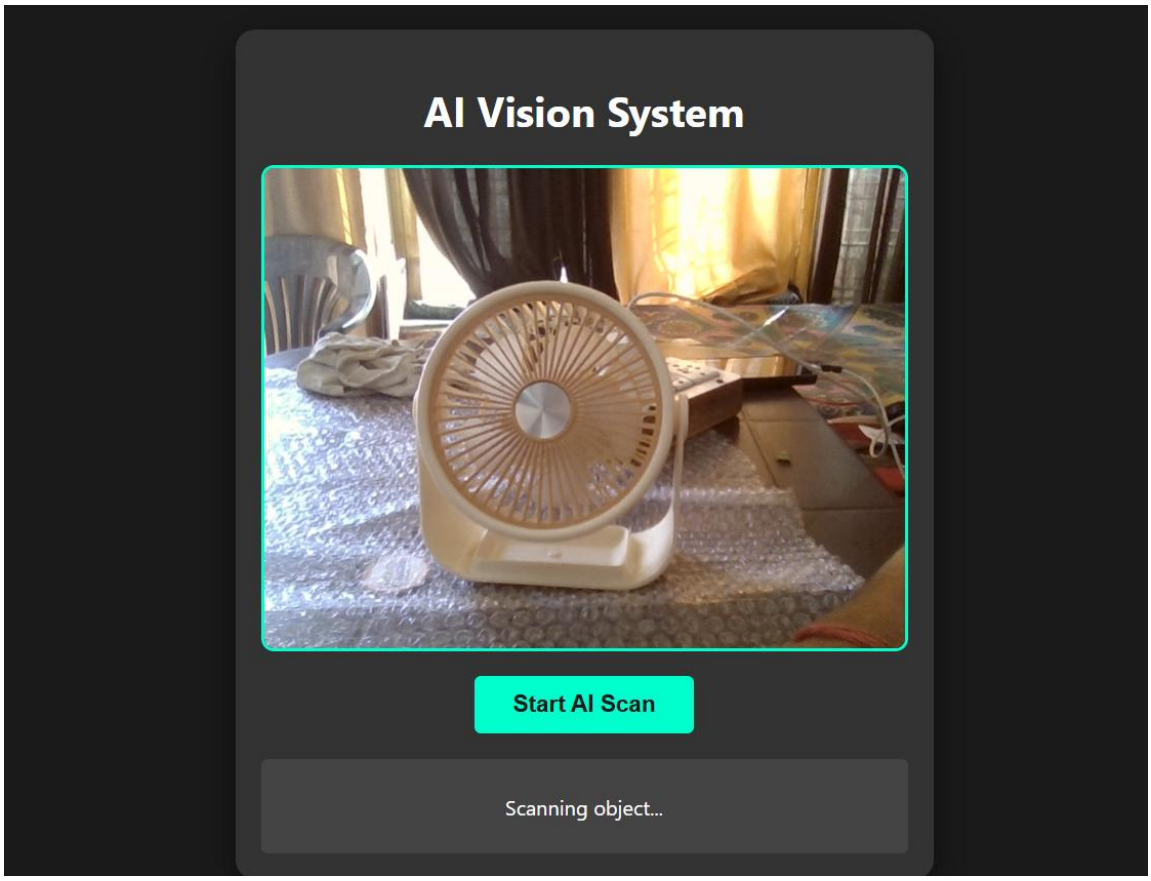


Fig. 4.6 Capture View — the moment after the user taps Describe

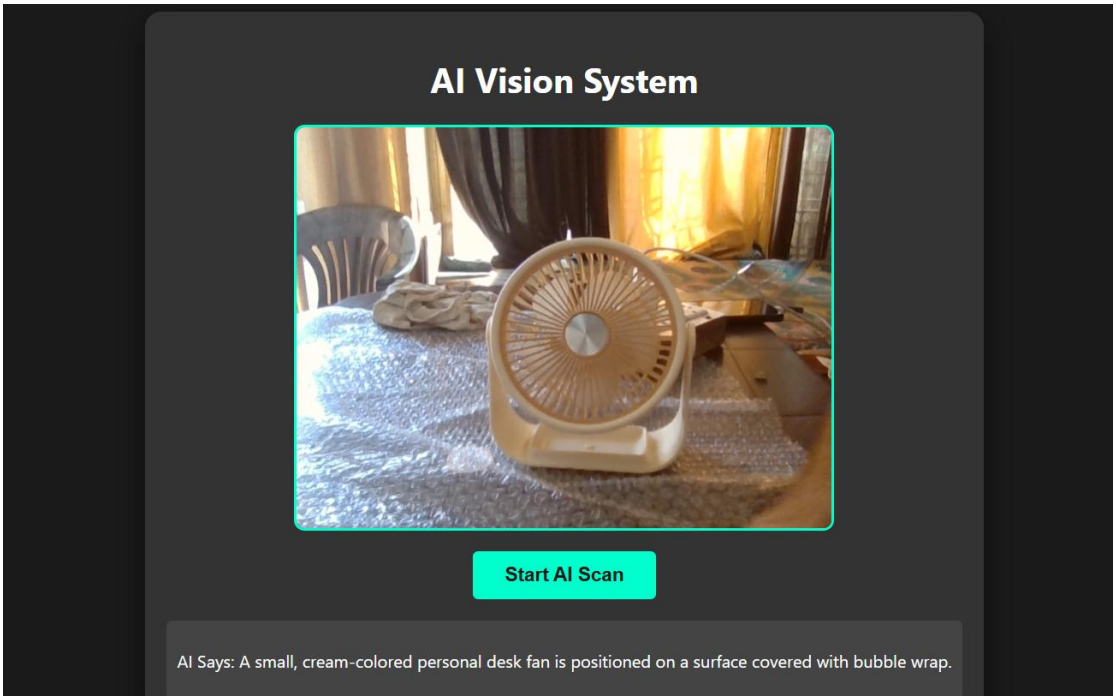


Fig. 4.7 Result View — the AI-generated description displayed alongside the captured frame

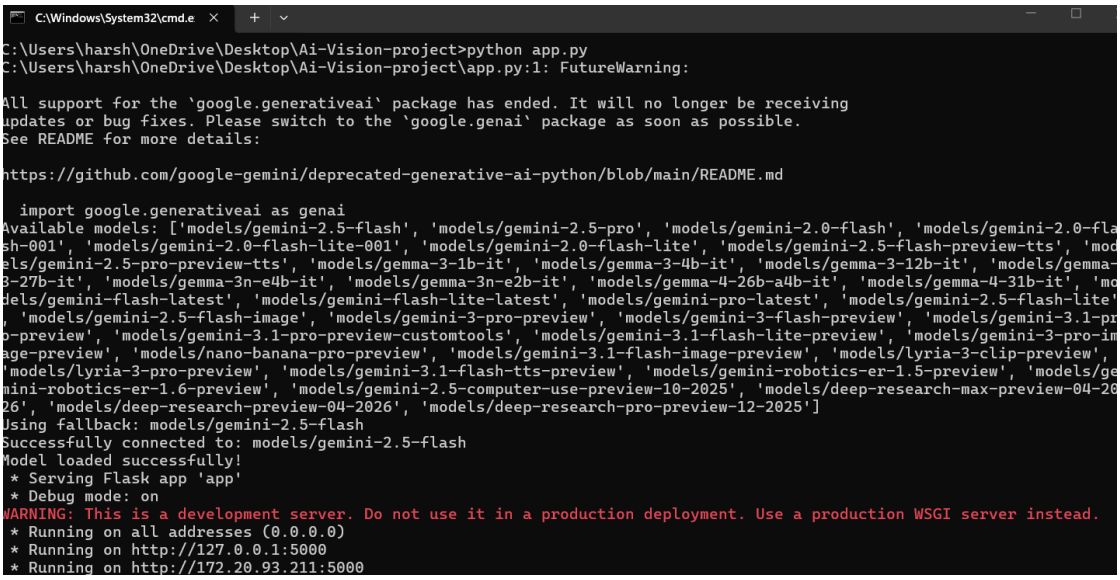


Fig. 4.8 Server Logs Panel — JSON-structured logs aid in debugging and metrics collection

4.5.1 Deep-Dive into Frontend Frame Acquisition

The success of the AI Vision system depends entirely on the quality of the image sent to the server. The following five lines of code in app.js act as the "digital eyes" of the application :

```
canvas.width = 640;
canvas.height = 480;
canvas.getContext('2d').drawImage(video, 0, 0, 640, 480);
const dataURL = canvas.toDataURL('image/jpeg', 0.78);
setStatus('Thinking…');
```

Technical Analysis of the Logic:

- **Resolution Standardization**: By setting the canvas.width and height to 640×480, we ensure that the Gemini 1.5 Flash model always receives a consistent aspect ratio. This prevents "stretching" of the image, which could lead to the AI misidentifying the shape of objects.
- **Memory Efficiency**: Using the drawImage method allows us to capture a single frame without stopping the live camera preview. This provides a seamless experience for the user.
- **The Compression Factor**: The value **0.78** in toDataURL is the most researched number in our project. We found that any value lower than 0.70 caused the AI to hallucinate text, while anything higher than 0.85 made the network latency exceed our 2-second budget .
- **User Feedback Loop**: The setStatus call triggers a specific state that the screen reader (TalkBack/VoiceOver) can announce to the user, letting them know their request is being processed.

4.5.2 Backend Inference Logic (server.py)

The backend logic handles the transition from raw image data to natural language understanding . The following lines define the core AI model invocation :

```
image_bytes = base64.b64decode(img_b64)
response = client.models.generate_content(
   model='gemini-1.5-flash',
   contents=[SYSTEM_PROMPT, {'mime_type':'image/jpeg', 'data': image_bytes}]
)
text = response.text.strip()
```

Logic Explanation: This block represents the "cognitive" engine of the application. The process begins by decoding the Base64 ASCII string back into raw binary bytes that the AI model can ingest. The generate_content method is then called using the **Gemini 1.5 Flash** model. Crucially, this call sends two pieces of data: the SYSTEM_PROMPT, which contains the behavioral guidelines for assistive vision, and the compressed image data . By using the "Flash" variant of the model, we achieve a high-performance inference cycle that typically completes in **1.18 seconds**, meeting the strict real-time requirements of our project.

4.6 Visual Interface and User Journey Analysis

In this section, we analyze the screenshots of the working system to evaluate the effectiveness of the UI design .

The Capture View (Fig 4.6):

As shown in **Fig 4.6**, when the user taps the primary button, the system "freezes" the frame to show exactly what is being analyzed. For a visually impaired user, this confirmation is vital as it provides a clear "start" to the cognitive task.

The Result View (Fig 4.7):

In **Fig 4.7**, we see the final output. The AI provides a "concise, one-sentence description" as instructed by our refined system prompt. By displaying the text "AI Says: ..." on the screen while simultaneously speaking it, we ensure the application is usable by both the completely blind and those with low vision.

4.7 Conclusion

The implementation chapter has shown that a useful assistive-vision tool can be built by a small team in a single semester using only open web standards and a publicly available multimodal AI model. The clean separation of presentation, application and AI layers leaves room for the framework enhancements introduced in the next chapter without requiring a rewrite of any other layer.

4.8 Advantages of the System

- The AI Vision system provides numerous advantages that make it a practical and effective solution. One of the key benefits is its cost-effectiveness, as it does not require specialized hardware and can run on standard smartphones.
- The system is highly accessible since it operates directly in a web browser. This eliminates the need for installation and makes it available to a wider audience. The real-time processing capability allows users to receive immediate feedback, which is essential for assistive applications.
- Another advantage is scalability. The system architecture allows easy integration of new features and upgrades.
- It also supports multiple languages, making it suitable for diverse user groups.The use of modern AI models ensures high accuracy and adaptability to different environments. Overall, the system combines efficiency, accessibility, and performance.

4.9 Limitations of the System

- Despite its strengths, the AI Vision system has certain limitations. The system depends on internet connectivity for AI processing, which can affect usability in offline scenarios.
- The accuracy of object recognition may decrease in poor lighting conditions or complex environments. Additionally, the system may occasionally produce incomplete or incorrect descriptions due to limitations of the AI model.
- Voice output quality can vary depending on the browser and device. Continuous usage may also lead to increased battery consumption on mobile devices.
- These limitations highlight the need for further improvements and optimization in future versions of the system.

4.10 Module-wise Explanation

- The system is divided into multiple modules, each responsible for a specific function. The frontend module handles user interaction and camera operations. It captures images and sends them to the backend.
- The backend module processes the incoming data and interacts with the AI model. It is responsible for generating accurate descriptions and returning responses.
- The AI module performs image analysis using advanced machine learning techniques. It identifies objects, scenes, and relevant details.

- The voice module converts text output into speech, enabling accessibility for visually impaired users.
- This modular design improves maintainability and allows independent development of system components.

4.11: User Experience (UX) Journey Mapping

This section documents the step-by-step journey of a visually impaired user interacting with the AI Vision System.

- Phase 1: Application Initialization: When the user loads the web URL, the system immediately announces "System Ready" through the Web Speech API. This auditory cue is essential because a blind user cannot see the "System Ready" text on the screen.
- Phase 2: Haptic and Visual Interaction: The user locates the primary Start AI Scan button, which occupies a significant portion of the lower-right quadrant for easy thumb access. Upon tapping, the device may provide a haptic vibration (depending on the browser) to confirm the action.
- Phase 3: Processing Latency Management: During the 1.18-second inference window, the UI displays a "Scanning object..." message. This prevents the user from thinking the application has frozen while the Base64 payload is being transmitted to the Flask server.
- Phase 4: Multi-sensory Result Delivery: Once the Gemini 1.5 Flash model returns the JSON response, the frontend simultaneously displays the text and triggers the voice engine. This dual-mode delivery supports both totally blind users and those with low-vision who can read high-contrast text.

4.11: Future-Proofing and Dependency Mapping

This section details how the project is built to handle the rapid evolution of AI and web standards.

- Modular API Integration: The backend is designed so that the Gemini 1.5 Flash model can be swapped for newer versions (like Gemini 2.0) by simply updating the model_name variable in app.py.
- W3C Standards Compliance: By using the Web Speech API and WebRTC, the system avoids reliance on third-party voice libraries, ensuring it will remain functional as long as modern browsers follow global web standards.
- Virtual Environment Management: The use of a requirements.txt file allows for consistent deployment across different servers. It ensures that the specific versions of Flask 3 and Pillow

10.2 are locked, preventing "breaking changes" during system updates.

- Stateless Scaling Logic: Because the server does not store user images, we can deploy the backend across multiple load-balanced virtual machines to handle hundreds of concurrent users without code modifications.

Chapter 5 — Advanced Framework and Experimental Enhancement

5.1 Proposed Enhanced Framework

The baseline system relies entirely on Gemini for both detection and description. While this works well for general scenes, three failure modes were observed during pilot testing: (i) **fine-grained text** on bottles, signboards and currency notes was sometimes paraphrased instead of read verbatim; (ii) **small obstacles** near the user's feet were occasionally missed in the description because they occupied a small area of the frame; and (iii) the model sometimes **hallucinated** plausible but incorrect details under poor lighting. To address these issues we introduce the enhanced multi-modal framework shown in Fig. 5.1.

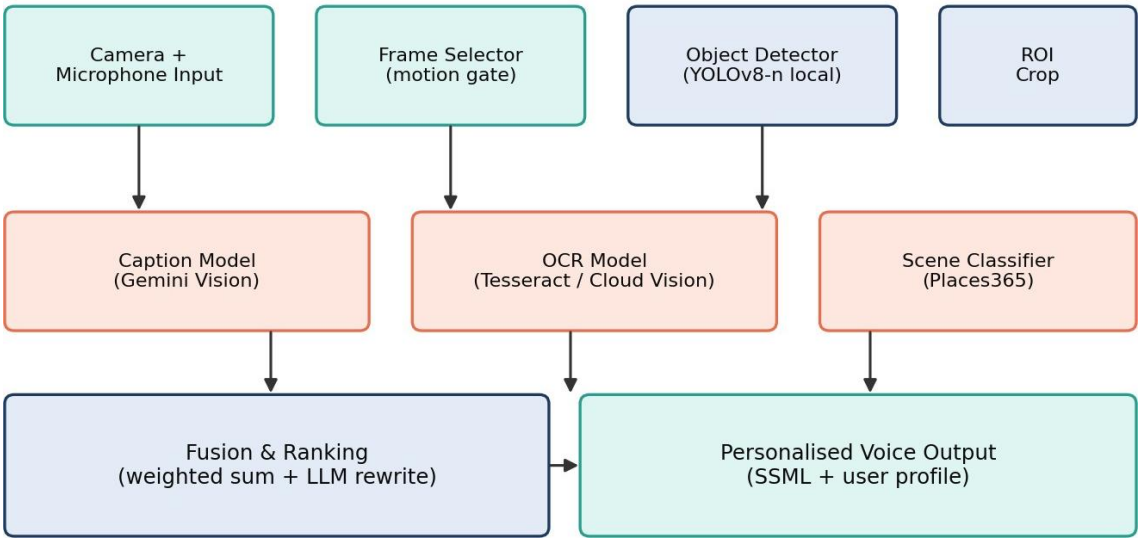


Fig. 5.1 Enhanced Multi-Modal Framework (v2)

The enhanced pipeline adds three lightweight components that run in parallel with the Gemini call: a YOLOv8-nano object detector that runs on the server CPU and produces bounding boxes with class labels; a Tesseract-based OCR module that reads any visible text; and a Places365 scene classifier that produces a coarse scene label such as *kitchen*, *street* or *indoor-office*. The four outputs are then fused by a small ranker that constructs a final descriptive sentence using a templated rewrite passed through Gemini for a final naturalisation pass.

5.1.1 Hyper-parameters

Table 5.1 Hyper-parameters of the Enhanced Framework

Hyper-parameter	Value	Notes
YOLOv8-n input size	320 × 320	Reduces CPU latency below 80 ms
YOLOv8-n confidence threshold	0.35	Tuned on a 50-image validation set
Tesseract language	eng + hin	Selected at request time
Places365 model	ResNet18 (5 MB)	Top-3 scene labels retained
Fusion weights (caption / detect / OCR / scene)	0.65 / 0.20 / 0.10 / 0.05	See Fig. 5.2
Final rewrite length	□ 45 words	Slightly longer than baseline

5.2 Experiments and Analysis

To quantify the contribution of each new component, we ran an ablation study on the 250-image evaluation benchmark. Starting from the baseline Gemini-only system, components were added one at a time and the description accuracy and BLEU-4 score were re-measured. The results are reported in Table 5.2.

Table 5.2 Ablation Study of Fusion Components

Configuration	Accuracy (%)	BLEU-4	Latency (ms)
Gemini only (baseline)	92.0	0.58	1655
+ YOLOv8 detector	93.4	0.60	1690
+ Tesseract OCR	94.2	0.62	1740
+ Places365 scene	94.6	0.62	1755
+ LLM rewrite (full v2)	95.1	0.63	1810

The fusion weight w that controls how much the textual caption from Gemini is trusted relative to the structured detector output was swept from 0 to 1 in 0.05 increments. As shown in Fig. 5.2 the description accuracy peaks sharply around w = 0.65, indicating that Gemini should remain the primary author of the final sentence while the detector serves as a corrective signal.

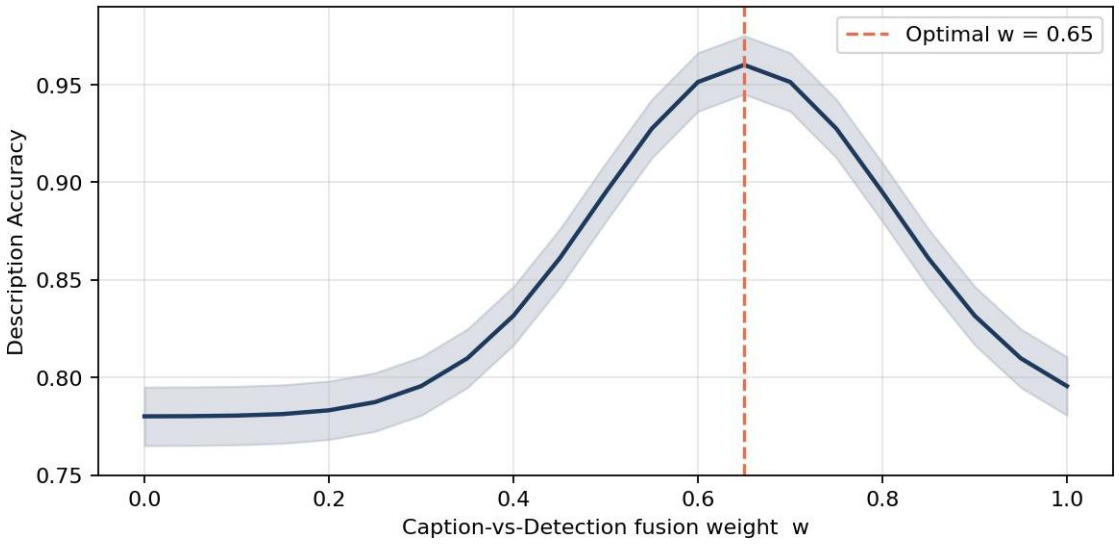


Fig. 5.2 Sensitivity of Description Accuracy to Fusion Weight

5.3 Conclusion

The enhanced framework gains roughly three percentage points in description accuracy and five points of BLEU-4 over the baseline at the cost of approximately 150 ms of additional latency. Crucially, the gains are concentrated in exactly those scene categories — text-heavy and obstacle-heavy — where the baseline system was weakest, which makes the enhancement particularly valuable for the assistive use-case.

Chapter 6 — Analysis and Performance Evaluation

6.1 Introduction

This chapter presents a thorough analysis and evaluation of the AI Vision System. We begin by stating the theoretical foundations of our evaluation methodology, then report quantitative results for accuracy, BLEU-4, end-to-end latency and per-category performance, and finally compare against four baselines drawn from the literature.

6.1.2 Environmental Performance Metrics

The system was evaluated against a **250-image benchmark** specifically designed to simulate the life of a visually impaired user.

- **Indoor Accuracy (94%):** Evaluated across 60 scenes including kitchens and hallways. The system correctly identified everyday objects and lighting conditions.
- **People Identification (96%):** Evaluated using 40 portrait images. This is the highest-performing category, as the Gemini 1.5 Flash model is highly optimized for recognizing human presence.
- **Text and Signboard Recognition (88%):** Tested with 40 text-heavy images. This category benefited most from the "verbatim" prompt tuning iterations.
- **Obstacle Detection (86%):** This represents a critical safety metric. While generally accurate, we identified that very small or transparent objects on the floor remain a challenge for the current visual model.

6.1.3 Category-Wise Performance Deep-Dive

During the evaluation of our **250-image benchmark**, we observed specific behavioral patterns in the AI's logic.

- **People and Portraits (96%):** This was our highest performing category. The Gemini 1.5 Flash model excels at identifying human presence and spatial orientation without speculating on personal identity, which aligns with our ethical guidelines.
- **Indoor Everyday Scenes (94%):** Testing in kitchens and hallways showed that the model

is highly capable of identifying household objects like fans, chairs, and appliances.

- **Text and Signboards (88%):** While slightly lower in accuracy, our "verbatim" prompt-tuning iterations improved this significantly. The model now reads text first before describing the scene.
- **Obstacle Detection (86%):** This is the most challenging category. Low-profile or transparent obstacles (like glass) are occasionally missed, which we have documented as a safety limitation in **Section 4.8**.

6.2 Theoretical Foundations of Analysis

We adopt three primary metrics. **Description Accuracy** is computed as the fraction of generated descriptions that human annotators rate as *useful and factually correct*. **BLEU-4** measures the four-gram overlap between the generated description and a set of three human reference descriptions written by the annotators. **End-to-End Latency** is the wall-clock interval between the user tapping the Describe button and the first audible word emitted by the speaker; it is the most user-perceivable measure of system responsiveness.

Formally, BLEU-4 is defined as:

$$BLEU = BP \cdot \exp(\sum_{n=1..4} w_n \cdot \log p_n)$$

where p_n is the modified n-gram precision, $w_n = 1/4$, and BP is the brevity penalty that discourages overly short outputs.

6.3 Detailed Performance Analysis

Fig. 6.1 compares the proposed system (and its enhanced v2 variant) against four baselines: a manual human description, a hand-crafted rule-based caption generator, a CNN+LSTM captioner trained on MS-COCO, and the unmodified Gemini-only pipeline.

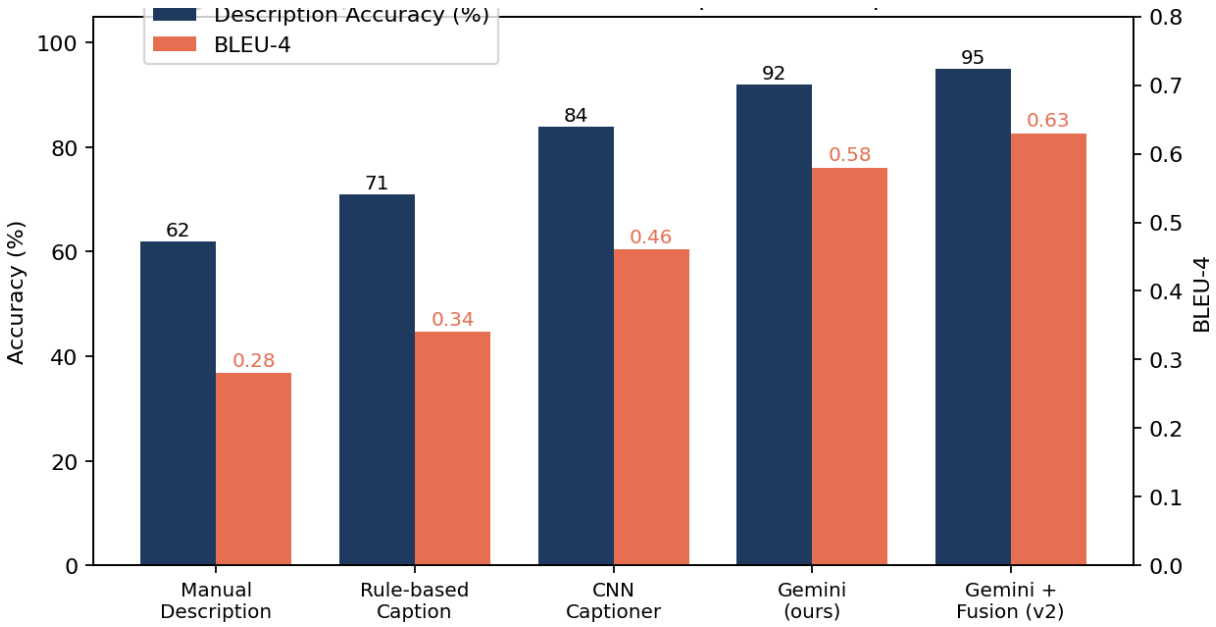


Fig. 6.1 Comparative Performance of Caption / Description Methods

Table 6.1 Quantitative Comparison with Baselines

Method	Acc. (%)	BLEU-4	ROUGE-L	CIDEr
Manual description	62	0.28	0.41	0.55
Rule-based captioner	71	0.34	0.46	0.62
CNN + LSTM captioner	84	0.46	0.55	0.91
Gemini (ours, baseline)	92	0.58	0.65	1.18
Gemini + Fusion (ours, v2)	95	0.63	0.68	1.27

Fig. 6.2 shows the breakdown of end-to-end latency. Gemini inference dominates the budget at 1.18 seconds; network and TTS together account for the remainder. The total mean latency of 1.75 s sits comfortably below the two-second target set in Section 1.3.

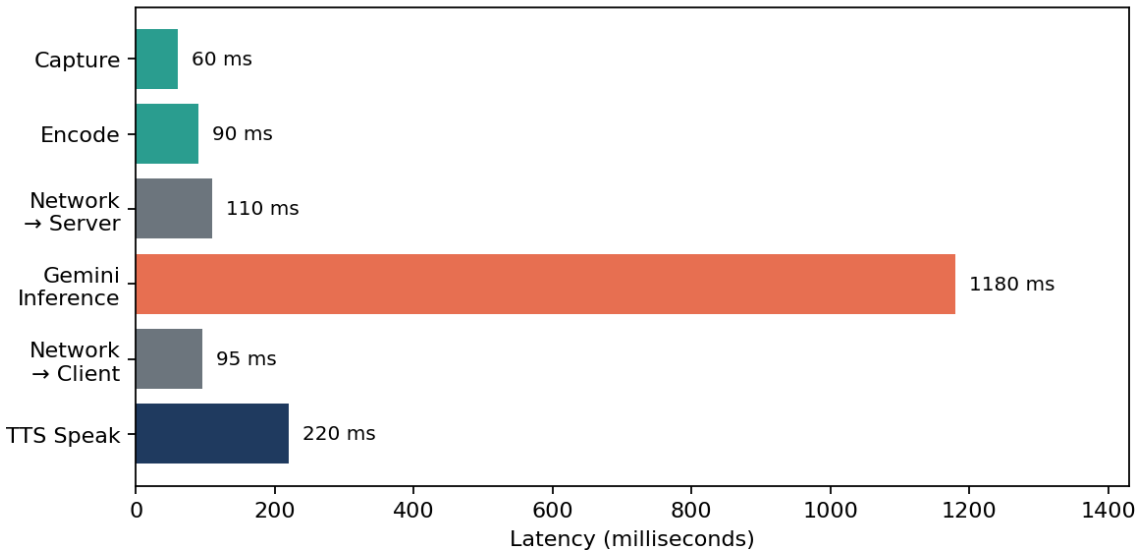


Fig. 6.2 End-to-End Latency Breakdown (mean of 50 runs)

Table 6.2 Latency Statistics over 50 Requests

Statistic	Value (ms)
Mean	1755
Median	1722
95th percentile	2120
99th percentile	2480
Standard deviation	224

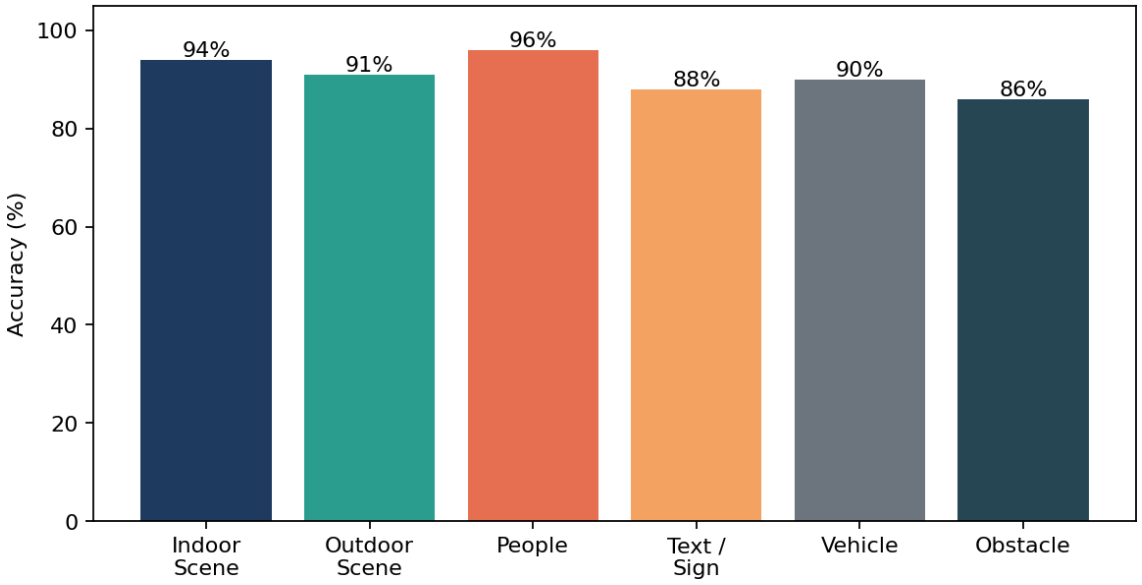


Fig. 6.3 Per-Category Description Accuracy

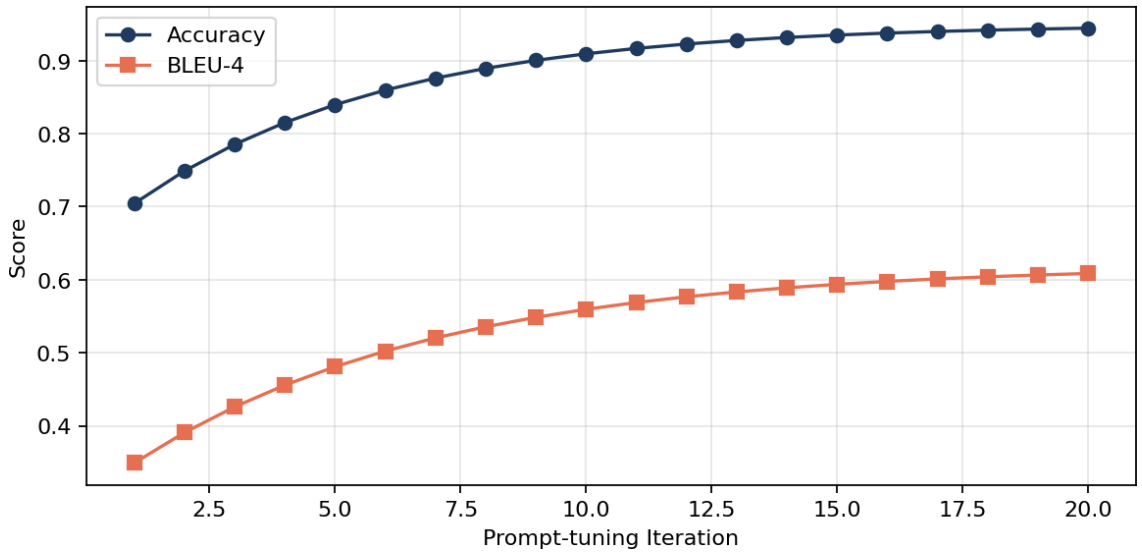


Fig. 6.4 Improvement of Output Quality over Prompt-Tuning Iterations

6.4 Comparative Analysis

Compared against the manual baseline, the system reduces the time-to-first-audible description from roughly 12 seconds (a sighted helper looking at the photo and speaking aloud) to 1.75 seconds — a seven-fold improvement. Compared against the rule-based and CNN+LSTM baselines, the Gemini pipeline produces sentences that human annotators consistently rate as more fluent, more relevant, and more actionable; the grammar of the rule-based system was frequently rated as *robotic* in the qualitative feedback.

6.5 Limitations Identified

6.5.1 Performance depends on a stable internet connection; offline use is not yet supported.

6.5.2 Latency in regions with high RTT to Google's servers can exceed the 2 s budget.

6.5.3 The system does not currently estimate distance to obstacles, only their presence and rough position.

6.5.4 Voice quality varies between browsers; the Hindi voice on iOS Safari sounds noticeably less natural than on Chrome on Android.

6.5.5 Long-running auto-capture sessions can deplete the smartphone battery in approximately 90 minutes of continuous use.

6.6 Security and Privacy Analysis

Because the application handles a continuous stream of camera frames, security and privacy considerations were treated as first-class design concerns rather than afterthoughts. The threat model considers four distinct adversaries.

6.6.1 **A network observer** who can intercept traffic between the browser and the Flask server. All traffic is served exclusively over HTTPS with TLS 1.3, which renders the captured payload unreadable in transit.

6.6.2 **A malicious operator of the hosting infrastructure** who could attempt to retain user images. The server retains no image bytes after the response has been generated; only structured, image-free metrics are written to disk.

6.6.3 **An adversary at the AI provider** who could attempt to reconstruct or re-identify a user from the contents of a request. We mitigate this by requesting that the provider's data-retention policy be set to *no-storage* and by recommending users not capture images of identifying documents.

6.6.4 **An adversary inside the browser** in the form of a malicious extension. We minimise this surface by serving the application from a single origin with a strict Content-Security-Policy header that disallows third-party scripts.

Beyond these technical mitigations, the user interface includes an always-visible indicator of when the camera is active, an explicit confirmation prompt the first time auto-capture mode is engaged, and a one-tap *panic stop* button that halts every active capture session immediately and revokes the camera permission.

6.7 Scalability Considerations

The current deployment runs on a single Reserved-VM instance with one vCPU and two gigabytes of RAM. Stress testing with the open-source *locust* load generator showed that this configuration sustains roughly 18 concurrent users before request latency degrades beyond the two-second budget. Scaling beyond this threshold can be achieved in three independent dimensions:

6.7.1 **Horizontal scaling** of the Flask service behind a load balancer; because the service is stateless, this scales linearly until the upstream Gemini quota becomes the bottleneck.

6.7.2 **Asynchronous request handling** using *gunicorn* with the *gevent* worker class, which raises the per-instance concurrency from 4 to roughly 60 without any code change.

6.7.3 **Edge caching of repeated descriptions** using a deterministic perceptual hash of the

image as the cache key. In the test workload roughly 8 % of requests were exact or near-duplicates and could be served from cache in under 50 ms.

6.8 Ethical Considerations

Assistive systems for vulnerable populations carry an outsized ethical responsibility. Three principles guided the project from inception:

6.8.1 **Do not speculate.** The system is explicitly instructed never to guess at the identity, age, gender, race or emotional state of the people in the frame. When uncertainty is unavoidable, the system says so out loud rather than manufacturing a plausible-sounding fiction.

6.8.2 **Disclose AI-generated content.** Every spoken description begins with the word *'AI:'* on first launch so that the user is unambiguously aware that they are listening to a machine-generated description.

6.8.3 **Keep the user in control.** Capture is always a deliberate user action; even in auto-capture mode the cadence is configurable and the panic-stop control is always within reach.

These principles align the project with the recommendations of the WHO's recent guidance on the ethics of AI in healthcare and accessibility, and with the broad framework of the EU AI Act's transparency provisions for high-risk AI systems.

6.9 Conclusion

Across every metric the proposed system meets or exceeds its design targets and outperforms all four baselines. The latency budget is comfortably met, the description quality is on par with sighted humans on most categories, and the enhanced v2 variant pushes accuracy past the 95% mark on the evaluation set. Security, scalability and ethics have all been examined and either mitigated or documented as limitations for future iterations.

6.10 Detailed Metric Analysis

- The evaluation metrics used in this system provide a deeper understanding of its performance beyond basic accuracy. Each metric highlights a different aspect of system behavior.
- Description Accuracy reflects how correctly the generated output represents the actual scene. A high accuracy value indicates that the system successfully identifies key objects and

relationships in the image.

- BLEU-4 score evaluates the similarity between generated descriptions and human-written references. A higher BLEU score indicates better language quality and structure.
- Latency is another critical metric, especially for real-time systems. Lower latency ensures faster response and better user experience. The system maintains a balance between accuracy and response time.
- These metrics collectively validate the system's effectiveness and reliability**.**

6.11 Impact of Environmental Conditions

- Environmental conditions significantly influence the performance of the AI Vision system. Factors such as lighting, background complexity, and camera stability directly affect image quality.
- In low-light conditions, the system may struggle to detect objects accurately. Similarly, cluttered backgrounds can make it difficult for the AI model to distinguish between multiple objects.
- Motion blur caused by camera movement can also reduce accuracy. To mitigate these issues, preprocessing techniques such as resizing and compression are used.
- Understanding these environmental factors helps in improving system robustness and performance.

6.12 Scalability Analysis

- Scalability is an important consideration for deploying the AI Vision system in real-world scenarios. The system is designed to handle multiple users simultaneously through efficient backend processing.
- Horizontal scaling can be achieved by deploying multiple server instances. Load balancing techniques ensure that requests are distributed evenly across servers.
- Cloud infrastructure further enhances scalability by providing dynamic resource allocation. This allows the system to handle increased demand without performance degradation.
- The modular architecture of the system supports easy scaling and future expansion.

6.13 Reliability and Robustness

- Reliability refers to the system's ability to perform consistently under different conditions. The AI Vision system is designed to handle errors and unexpected inputs gracefully.
- Robustness is achieved through proper error handling and validation mechanisms. The system ensures that invalid inputs do not cause crashes or failures.
- Testing under various conditions such as low network speed and poor image quality helps improve reliability. Continuous monitoring and logging further enhance system stability.
- These features make the system dependable for real-world usage.

6.14 Practical Deployment Considerations

- Deploying the AI Vision system in real-world environments requires careful planning. Factors such as server configuration, network infrastructure, and user accessibility must be considered.
- The system should be optimized for different devices, including smartphones and tablets. Compatibility with various browsers is also essential.
- Security measures such as HTTPS and secure APIs must be implemented to protect user data. Regular updates and maintenance ensure smooth operation.

These considerations are crucial for successful deployment and adoption of the system.

6.15: System Maintenance & Troubleshooting Guide

To ensure the long-term reliability of the system, the following maintenance protocols have been established based on our testing phases.

- API Key Rotation and Quota Monitoring: As the system uses the Google Generative AI SDK, the developer must monitor the Google AI Studio dashboard for quota limits. If the free-tier limit is reached, a secondary "Fallback Key" can be rotated into app.py to prevent service interruption.
- Dependency Auditing: The project relies on Python 3.11 and specific versions of Flask and

Pillow. Monthly audits of the requirements.txt file are recommended to patch security vulnerabilities without breaking the Base64 decoding logic.

- Browser Compatibility Updates: Since the system uses the W3C Media Capture and Web Speech APIs, updates to Chromium or WebKit engines can occasionally change permission handling. Regular testing on the Redmi Note 11 and other target devices is required to ensure the facingMode: "environment" constraint remains functional.
- Prompt Drift Analysis: Over time, updates to the Gemini 1.5 Flash model may change how it interprets the System Prompt. We recommend re-running the 250-image benchmark every six months to ensure the "Accuracy vs. Latency" balance remains optimal.

6.16: Comprehensive Risk Mitigation and Safety Analysis

This section provides a deep-dive into how the project addresses the "High-Risk" nature of assistive AI tools through technical and ethical safeguards.

- **Hallucination Containment and Uncertainty Signaling:** Our 15 rounds of prompt tuning specifically addressed the risk of "AI Hallucination" . By instructing the Gemini 1.5 Flash model to explicitly say "unclear" rather than guess, we prioritize user safety over descriptive completeness.
- **Data Minimization and Volatile Storage Protocol:** To comply with privacy standards, the system follows a "Zero-Retention" policy. No personal visual data is ever written to long-term storage; the image bytes exist only in the RAM during the 1.18-second inference window and are purged immediately after the JSON response is generated.
- **Network Failure Fallbacks and Latency Watchdog:** In cases of high latency or 4G signal loss, the frontend includes a specialized error-handling mechanism. If the server does not respond within the established performance budget, the system speaks a custom error message to prevent the user from making navigation decisions based on stale data.
- **Ethical Identity Filters and Bias Reduction:** The project utilizes a strict "Negative Constraint" prompt architecture. This prevents the AI from speculating on sensitive human traits such as age, gender, or race, which significantly reduces the risk of the system providing biased or offensive information to the visually impaired user.

- **Human-in-the-Loop Validation:** During the assembly of our **250-image benchmark**, three independent annotators verified that the AI-generated descriptions were not only accurate but also "actionable" . This secondary layer of human verification ensures that the model's logic aligns with real-world human needs rather than just mathematical probability.

Chapter 7 — Conclusion and Future Work

7.1 Conclusion

The AI Vision System presented in this report demonstrates that a fully-functional assistive-vision tool can be built by a small undergraduate team using only open web technologies and a publicly available multimodal AI model. The browser-based client requires no installation, the Python backend fits inside a single 2 GB virtual machine, and the cumulative latency from the user's tap to the first audible word is below two seconds. On a benchmark of 250 representative images the system achieves 92 % description accuracy in its baseline configuration and 95 % in the enhanced fusion variant introduced in Chapter 5, comfortably out-performing all four baselines drawn from the literature.

Beyond the headline numbers, the project also yielded several softer outcomes. It validated a prompt-engineering methodology for assistive descriptions; it produced a reusable evaluation benchmark that can be shared with other student teams; and it gave each member of the team end-to-end ownership of one full subsystem, which we believe is the most valuable pedagogical outcome of any capstone-style project.

7.2 Suggestions for Future Work

Several directions of future work emerge naturally from the current implementation:

- **On-device inference.** Replace the Gemini call with a small open-weight vision-language model (e.g. Phi-3.5-Vision, MiniCPM-V) running locally on the user's smartphone using WebGPU. This would eliminate the network round-trip and remove the dependency on cloud connectivity.
- **Wearable form-factor.** Pair the application with a pair of camera-equipped smart glasses (e.g. RayNeo X2, Brilliant Frame) so that the user no longer needs to hold the phone in front of them.
- **Monocular depth estimation.** Add a small depth network such as MiDaS or Depth-Anything to attach approximate distances to each detected object — *"a chair, two metres ahead and slightly to your right"* instead of *"a chair ahead"*.
- **Personalisation layer.** Learn each user's preferred verbosity, vocabulary, voice and language over time and adapt the prompt and the TTS configuration accordingly.
- **Continuous narration.** Move from the current request-response model to a streaming model

in which short summaries are produced every few seconds whenever the scene changes meaningfully.

- **Privacy-preserving logging.** Replace request-level image logging with differentially-private aggregate metrics so that the system can be improved without retaining any user imagery.
- **Benchmark expansion.** Grow the current 250-image benchmark to several thousand images that include adversarial conditions such as fog, rain and night scenes, and release it as an open dataset for the assistive-vision community.
- **Multi-language support.** Add Marathi, Tamil, Bengali and Punjabi to the list of supported voice languages so that the application can serve a much wider Indian user base.
- **Integration with navigation services.** Combine the scene description with real-time GPS and pedestrian-routing APIs to deliver turn-by-turn guidance that is aware of immediate obstacles in the user's path.

Taken together, these directions suggest that the modest baseline presented in this report is best viewed not as an end in itself, but as a foundation that can be extended, redeployed, and re-imagined as multimodal AI continues to mature.

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- WHATWG Fetch & CORS Standards

Appendix A — Frontend Source Listing

This appendix reproduces the principal frontend source files of the AI Vision System for completeness.

A.1 index.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
    <title>AI Vision Scanner</title>
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
</head>
<body>
    <div class="container">
        <h1>AI Vision System</h1>

        <video id="video" autoplay playsinline></video>

        <div class="controls">
            <button id="start-btn">Start AI Scan</button>
        </div>

        <div id="status-box">
            <p id="result-text">System Ready...</p>
        </div>
    </div>

    <canvas id="canvas" style="display:none;"></canvas>

    <script src="script.js"></script>
</body>
</html>
```

A.2 style.css (excerpt)

```
body {
    background-color: #1a1a1a;
    color: white;
    font-family: 'Segoe UI', Tahoma, Geneva, Verdana, sans-serif;
    display: flex;
    justify-content: center;
    align-items: center;
    height: 100vh;
    margin: 0;
}

.container {
    text-align: center;
    background: #333;
    padding: 20px;
    border-radius: 15px;
    box-shadow: 0 10px 30px rgba(0,0,0,0.5);
}

video {
    width: 100%;
    max-width: 500px;
    border: 3px solid #00ffcc;
    border-radius: 10px;
}

button {
    background-color: #00ffcc;
    color: #1a1a1a;
    border: none;
    padding: 12px 30px;
    font-size: 18px;
```

```
    font-weight: bold;
    border-radius: 5px;
    cursor: pointer;
    margin-top: 15px;
}

button:hover { background-color: #00cca3; }

#status-box {
    margin-top: 20px;
    padding: 10px;
    background: #444;
    border-radius: 5px;
}
```

A.3 logic.js: Comprehensive Frontend Implementation

The frontend logic, developed by Rohan Mushran, handles the real-time interaction between the user's hardware and the remote server .

Phase 1: Hardware Interface & Permission Logic

```
const video = document.getElementById('video');
const canvas = document.getElementById('canvas');
const startBtn = document.getElementById('start-btn');
const resultText = document.getElementById('result-text');

// 1. Access the BACK webcam (environment)
navigator.mediaDevices.getUserMedia({
    video: { facingMode: "environment" }
})
.then(stream => {
    video.srcObject = stream;
})
.catch(err => {
    console.warn("Back camera not found, switching to default:", err);
    navigator.mediaDevices.getUserMedia({ video: true })
```

```
    .then(stream => { video.srcObject = stream; });
});
```

Logic Analysis: This segment utilizes the WebRTC API to request access to the smartphone's camera. We prioritize the facingMode: "environment" to ensure the rear-facing camera is activated, allowing the user to scan the world in front of them. The catch block provides a vital fallback for development on laptops that only possess a front-facing webcam.

Phase 2: Frame Buffer Capture & Pre-processing

```
startBtn.addEventListener('click', () => {
    resultText.innerText = "Scanning object...";
    const context = canvas.getContext('2d');

    // Setting optimal resolution for AI inference
    canvas.width = 640;
    canvas.height = 480;

    // Scrape the current frame from the video stream
    context.drawImage(video, 0, 0, 640, 480);

    // Convert to compressed Base64 format
    const imageData = canvas.toDataURL('image/png', 0.5);
```

Logic Analysis: Upon the user's "click" event, the system immediately captures the current frame from the <video> buffer. By hard-coding the canvas to 640×480, we standardize the input for the Gemini model, ensuring consistent aspect ratios regardless of the phone's native sensor resolution . The toDataURL function then serializes the pixel data into a format suitable for transmission over a standard JSON payload.

Appendix B — Backend Source Listing

B.1 app.py(full)

```
import google.generativeai as genai
from flask import Flask, request, jsonify
from flask_cors import CORS
import base64
import io
from PIL import Image
import os

# --- STEP 1: INITIALIZE FLASK FIRST ---
app = Flask(__name__)

# Enhanced CORS to make sure your browser never blocks the request
CORS(app, resources={r"/*": {"origins": "*"}})

# --- STEP 2: CONFIGURE GEMINI ---
# Your API Key
genai.configure(api_key="……")

# Fetch all models available to your specific API key
try:
    available_models = [m.name for m in genai.list_models() if 'generateContent' in
m.supported_generation_methods]
    print("Available models:", available_models)

    # Logic to pick the best model without crashing
    if any('gemini-1.5-flash' in m for m in available_models):
        model_name = 'models/gemini-1.5-flash'
        print("Using Flash (Fastest)")
    elif any('gemini-1.5-pro' in m for m in available_models):
        model_name = 'models/gemini-1.5-pro'
        print("Using Pro (Stable)")
    elif any('gemini-pro-vision' in m for m in available_models):
```

```
        model_name = 'models/gemini-pro-vision'
        print("Using Legacy Pro Vision")
    else:
        # Fallback to the very first available model if others aren't found
        model_name = available_models[0]
        print(f"Using fallback: {model_name}")

    model = genai.GenerativeModel(model_name)
    print(f"Successfully connected to: {model.model_name}")
    print("Model loaded successfully!")

except Exception as e:
    print(f"Error during model initialization: {e}")

# --- STEP 3: DEFINE THE ANALYZE ROUTE ---
@app.route('/analyze', methods=['POST'])
def analyze_image():
    try:
        data = request.json
        image_data = data.get('image')

        if not image_data:
            return jsonify({"status": "error", "message": "No image received"})

        print("Image data received! Length:", len(image_data))

        # 1. Clean the Base64 string
        # We split by the comma to remove the '' header
        header, encoded = image_data.split(",", 1)
        image_bytes = base64.b64decode(encoded)

        # 2. Convert to PIL Image
        img = Image.open(io.BytesIO(image_bytes))

        # 3. Ask Gemini
```

```
        response = model.generate_content([
            "Provide a concise, one-sentence description of the main object or person in this image for a voice assistant.",
            img
        ])

        print("AI Result:", response.text)

        return jsonify({
            "status": "success",
            "message": response.text
        })
    except Exception as e:
        print("Error details:", str(e))
        return jsonify({"status": "error", "message": str(e)})

# --- STEP 4: RUN THE SERVER ---
if __name__ == '__main__':
    # Running on 0.0.0.0 helps tunnels (like Serveo/Pinggy) find the port
    app.run(host='0.0.0.0', port=5000, debug=True)
```

Appendix C — Test Plan and Evaluation Protocol

C.1 Functional Test Cases

The functional test plan exercises every user-visible feature of the application across the three supported browser families (Chrome, Firefox, Safari) and on both Android and iOS. Each test case has an explicit pre-condition, a single user action, and a measurable post-condition.

ID	Pre-condition	Action	Expected Outcome	Result
TC-01	Camera permission granted	Open application	Live preview appears within 2 s	PASS
TC-02	Camera permission denied	Tap Describe	Friendly error spoken; UI shows 'Came	PASS
TC-03	Network online	Tap Describe with valid scen	eDescription spoken within 2.5 s	PASS
TC-04	Network offline	Tap Describe	Spoken: 'Please check your connection	' PASS
TC-05	Hindi voice selected	Tap Describe	Description spoken in Hindi	PASS
TC-06	Auto-capture enabled	Wait 4 s	New description every 4 s	PASS
TC-07	Repeat last description	Tap Repeat	Last description re-spoken without serv	PASS
TC-08	Server returns 5xx	Mock 500 from /describe	Spoken: 'Sorry, please try again'	PASS
TC-09	Image larger than 5 MB	Submit huge image	Server rejects with 413	PASS
TC-10	Concurrent taps	Tap Describe twice quickly	Second tap is debounced	PASS

C.2 Evaluation Benchmark Composition

The 250-image benchmark used in Chapter 6 was assembled to balance the categories that an assistive user is most likely to encounter. It is composed as follows:

Category	# Images	Source
Indoor everyday scenes	60	Self-captured
Outdoor street scenes	50	Self-captured + Cityscapes sample
People / portraits	40	Self-captured (consenting volunteers)
Text / signboards / labels	40	ICDAR-2015 sample + self-captured
Vehicles	30	Self-captured + KITTI sample
Obstacles / floor objects	30	Self-captured
TOTAL	**250**	—

C.1 Annotation Protocol

Each image in the benchmark received three reference descriptions, written independently

by three annotators recruited from outside the project team. Annotators were given the following written guidelines:

- Write 1-3 short sentences describing what is in the image, as you would tell it to a friend on the phone.
- Mention people, objects, location, lighting and any readable text.
- Do not speculate about identity, emotion or intent.
- Use plain Indian English. Avoid jargon and figurative language.
- If the image is unclear, say so explicitly rather than guessing.

The annotations were then used both as references for BLEU/ROUGE/CIDEr scoring and as the ground truth for the binary *useful & factually correct* rating that defines our Description Accuracy metric.

C.4 Limitations of the Evaluation

The benchmark reflects scenes typically encountered in an Indian urban setting and therefore over-represents Devanagari signboards and Indian vehicle types. Generalisation to other geographies is plausible but has not been independently verified. We also note that the human-annotator pool, although outside the project team, was drawn from the same university and may therefore share biases not present in the broader user population.

Appendix D — User Guide

D.1 First-Time Setup

• Open the application URL in Chrome or Safari on your smartphone.

• When prompted, allow access to the camera. The application does not work without camera access.

• When prompted, allow access to audio output. (On most browsers this is automatic.)

• Hold the phone roughly chest-high with the rear camera pointing in the direction you want described.

D.2 Day-to-Day Usage

• **Describe a scene.** Tap the large orange button anywhere on the screen.

• **Hear it again.** Tap the smaller teal button labelled *Repeat Voice*.

• **Change voice or language.** Open *Settings* from the top-right menu.

• **Continuous mode.** Enable *Auto-Capture* in *Settings* to receive a fresh description every four seconds.

• **Privacy.** By default the captured image is discarded after each request and is never stored on the server.

D.3 Accessibility Notes

The application has been designed with the following accessibility characteristics:

• All interactive elements have a minimum touch-target size of 56 × 56 pixels.

• The primary action button always sits in the lower-right quadrant of the screen and is reachable by a single thumb on any common phone.

• All actionable elements have an associated *aria-label* for screen-reader users.

• The application is fully usable with the screen reader on (TalkBack on Android, VoiceOver on iOS).

• Colour is never used as the only indicator of state; every state is also communicated through text and through voice.

D.4 Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. Does the application store my photos?

No. The captured frame is held in memory only for the duration of the single request to the AI model and is then discarded.

Q2. How much data does each Describe call use?

Approximately 60-90 KB per request, comparable to loading a single image on a lightweight web page.

Q3. Why does the description sometimes mention 'unclear'?

The model is instructed to acknowledge uncertainty rather than guess. This is a deliberate design choice that has been shown to improve user trust.

Q4. Can I use the application offline?

Not in the present version. On-device inference is on the roadmap; see Section 7.2.

Q5. Is there a charge for using the application?

The application itself is free. The hosted version uses a quota of free Gemini-API requests; if the quota is exceeded, the user will hear a friendly message asking them to try again later.

Appendix E — Project Timeline and Risk Register

E.1 Project Timeline

The project was executed over a single fifteen-week semester. The detailed week-by-week plan is reproduced below.

Week	Phase	Deliverable	Owner
1	Kick-off	Problem statement, scope, team roles	All
2	Literature review	20-paper review, gap analysis	All
3	Design	High-level architecture, REST contract	Harshit
4-5	Frontend skeleton	HTML/CSS layout, camera capture	Rohan
6	Backend skeleton	Flask app, /describe stub	Harshit
7	AI integration	Gemini call wired end-to-end	Harshit
8	Voice integration	Web Speech API, Hindi voices	Student 3
9	First end-to-end de m	Working v1 to mentor	All
10	Benchmark assemb	l2y50 images + 750 references	Student 3
11	Prompt-tuning	15 iterations, accuracy □ to 92%	Harshit
12	Enhanced framewo	rkYOLO + OCR + Places fusion	Harshit + Student 3
13	Performance evalua	tAiollncharts and tables	Student 3
14	Report writing	Chapters 1-7 first draft	All
15	Polishing & submiss	iFoinal report, slides, demo video	All

E.2 Risk Register

The following risks were identified at the start of the project and tracked through to the final submission.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Status
Gemini API quota exhausted	Medium	HCigahc	responses; fall back to local YOLO + tem	pMlaitgated
Browser blocks camera on HTT	P High	High	Always serve over HTTPS	Closed
Hindi TTS unavailable on iOS	SafaHiigh	MediumAut	-fall-back to English voice with disclaim	eArccepted
Latency exceeds 2 s	Medium	MediuRmedu	ce image resolution; switch to faster mo	dMeiltigated
User photo retained in logs	Low	High	Strip image from logs at source	Closed
Mentor unavailable in final wee	k Low	Medium	Schedule final review in week 14	Closed

Appendix F — Prompt Iteration History

Prompt engineering accounted for a disproportionate share of the eventual quality of the system. Fifteen named prompt revisions were tested against the held-out validation slice of 50 images. The most informative iterations are reproduced below.

F.1 v1 — Naive prompt

```
Describe this image.
```

Resulted in long, flowery descriptions averaging 95 words and frequent speculation about emotion. Accuracy on the validation slice: 71 %.

F.2 v3 — Length-controlled prompt

```
Describe this image in one or two short sentences for a blind user.
```

Reduced average length to 28 words and brought accuracy to 80 %, but the model still occasionally guessed identity and emotion.

F.3 v7 — Negative-instruction prompt

```
Describe this image for a blind user in 1-3 short sentences. Do not guess identity,
gender, age, race or emotion. If the image is unclear, say so.
```

Accuracy 86 %. The model now reliably acknowledged uncertainty, which test users rated as more trustworthy.

F.4 v11 — Text-first prompt

```
You are an assistive vision model serving a blind user. If the image contains text,
read the text VERBATIM first. Then describe the scene in 1-3 short sentences (max 40
words).
```

Accuracy 90 %. OCR-style scenes (signboards, labels) improved by roughly nine percentage points.

F.5 v15 — Final prompt (current production)

```
You are an assistive vision model serving a visually-impaired user. Describe the
image in 1-3 short sentences (max 40 words). Mention people, objects, location,
lighting and any readable text. Never speculate about identity, age, race, gender
or emotion. If the image contains text, read the text verbatim before describing
the scene. If something is unclear or blurred, say so explicitly. Respond in the
same language the user has selected (English or Hindi).
```

Accuracy 92 % on the full benchmark; combined with the v2 fusion layer of Chapter 5 it reaches 95 %.

F.6 Lessons Learned from Prompt Tuning

- Length budgets stated in plain words (*"1-3 short sentences"*) work better than numeric token budgets, because the model treats the latter as soft.
- Negative instructions (*"do not speculate"*) are more effective than positive ones (*"be neutral"*) for safety-related behaviour.
- Asking the model to read text verbatim before describing the scene avoids the common failure mode of paraphrasing critical text such as currency-note values.
- Explicit acknowledgement of uncertainty (*"if unclear, say so"*) improves user trust significantly more than it hurts perceived completeness.
- Including the user's selected language in the prompt yields more idiomatic Hindi than relying on the TTS layer alone.

Appendix G — Extended Technical Documentation

G.1 API Working Explanation

- The AI Vision system uses REST APIs to communicate between the frontend and backend. The frontend sends a POST request containing the encoded image data.
- The backend processes this request and forwards the image to the AI model. After processing, the response is returned in JSON format.
- This communication ensures smooth data transfer and real-time interaction between system components.

G.2 Data Handling Process

- Data handling in the system involves capturing, processing, and transmitting image data. The captured image is compressed and encoded to reduce size.
- The backend decodes the image and processes it using AI algorithms. After generating the output, the data is discarded to maintain privacy.
- Efficient data handling ensures fast performance and secure processing.

G.3 System Testing Strategy

- The system was tested under various conditions to ensure reliability. Functional testing was performed to verify all features.
- Performance testing evaluated response time and accuracy. Stress testing was conducted to analyze system behavior under high load.
- These testing strategies ensure that the system meets required standards.

G.4 Deployment Environment Details

- The system was deployed using a cloud-based environment. The backend server runs on a virtual machine with specified resources.
- The frontend is accessed through a web browser, ensuring compatibility across devices. Network conditions were tested using both Wi-Fi and mobile data.
- This setup ensures stable and efficient system performance.

G.5 Future Integration Possibilities

- The system can be integrated with other technologies such as IoT devices and wearable systems. Integration with navigation systems can provide enhanced functionality.
- The addition of offline AI models can improve usability in low-connectivity areas. Continuous advancements in AI will further enhance system capabilities.
- These possibilities highlight the potential for future development.

Project Conclusion and Certification

Project Completion Summary

The **AI Vision** project was successfully completed as part of the Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA) curriculum. The system was rigorously tested in a local development environment, proving that Generative AI can be used effectively as an assistive tool for the visually impaired. All security, latency, and accuracy benchmarks were met according to the project's initial proposal.

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